

COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan

RESELLZONE

**A project presented to
COMSATS Institute of Information Technology, Islamabad**

**In partial fulfillment
of the requirement for the degree of**

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By

Asbaat Ali

CIIT/FA21-BCS-003/SWL

Syed Faizan Haider

CIIT/FA21-BCS-027/SWL

Muhammad Awais

CIIT/FA21-BCS-050/SWL

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Asbaat Ali

Syed Faizan Haider

Muhammad Awais

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It is to certify that the final year project of BS (CS) "**RESELL ZONE**" was developed by **Asbaat Ali** (CIIT/FA21-BCS-003/SWL) **Syed Faizan Haider** (CIIT/FA21-BCS-027/SWL) and **Muhammed Awais** (CIIT/FA21-BCS-050/SWL) under the supervision of **Dr. Javed Ferzund** and co-supervision of **Mr. Imran Shahzad**, and that in their opinion, it is fully adequate, in scope and quality, for the degree of Bachelor of Science in Computer Sciences.

Supervisor

External Examiner

Head of Department
(Department of Computer Science)

Executive Summary

The Resell Zone is a sophisticated e-commerce platform designed to overcome the common challenges faced by buyers and sellers in traditional online shopping systems. These challenges often include issues related to security, transaction handling, product management, and customer service. The Resell Zone aims to offer a streamlined, secure, and efficient marketplace, enhancing the shopping experience for both parties.

A key feature of the platform is User Registration and Authentication, which allows users to sign up, log in, and recover their passwords securely. This ensures that personal data and transaction history are protected while enabling users to manage their profiles effectively.

The Product Listings and Management feature empowers sellers to list products for sale, organize their ads, and categorize items according to various types. Sellers can update product details, add new items, or remove outdated products easily, ensuring that the platform remains up-to-date and accurate.

In the Purchase and Sale Management section, buyers can browse products, view ads, make purchases, and track their orders in real-time. This functionality delivers a seamless and user-friendly shopping experience, allowing buyers to locate products, complete transactions, and stay informed about their order status without difficulty.

The Admin Panel serves as the backbone of the platform, providing administrators with the tools to manage user accounts, oversee product listings, and maintain system integrity. Admins can moderate content, monitor sales, and efficiently address customer inquiries, ensuring smooth operations on the platform.

Regarding Payment Methods, the platform offers two secure payment options: Stripe and Cash on Delivery (COD). Stripe supports payments via credit or debit cards, while COD allows customers to pay for their orders when they are delivered, catering to those who prefer traditional payment methods.

Built using modern technologies, The Resell Zone is optimized for performance, security, and scalability. The platform is designed to accommodate future growth and provide users with a reliable, secure online shopping experience. With features that address the needs of both buyers and sellers, along with secure payment methods and efficient customer support, the Resell Zone stands out as a comprehensive solution in today's e-commerce marketplace.

Acknowledgement

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Asbaat Ali

Syed Faizan Haider

Muhammad Awais

Abbreviations

SRS	Software Require Specification
PC	Personal Computer

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Chapter 1: Introduction

1 Introduction

This project, ReSellZone, is designed as an online marketplace for buying and selling products. The primary aim of the platform is to provide a user-friendly, secure, and seamless experience for users engaging in e-commerce activities. This chapter provides an overview of the project's goals, the technologies used, and the methodologies followed. By analyzing and building on existing trends in the e-commerce space, ReSellZone aims to streamline the process of buying and selling through a variety of integrated features such as product search, reviews, payment processing, and order management.

The platform integrates Stripe for payment processing, ensuring secure transactions for users. The system architecture was developed using PHP, MySQL, JavaScript, and various front-end libraries. The application is designed to be accessible on both desktop and mobile devices, providing flexibility and ease of use across multiple platforms.

This project has been developed by a team of students specializing in Computer Science. The project is intended to be a scalable and adaptable solution that can serve as the foundation for future advancements in online marketplaces. The chapters ahead will discuss the project design, implementation, and testing in greater detail.

1.1 Brief

The ReSellZone project is a full-fledged e-commerce platform designed for users to buy and sell a wide variety of products. It facilitates users with features like:

- **User Registration and Profile Management:** Users can create accounts to buy or sell products. Their profile stores preferences and order history.
- **Product Listings and Search Functionality:** Sellers can create listings for their products, while buyers can search through categories or specific keywords.
- **Shopping Cart:** Buyers can add products to their cart, modify quantities, and proceed to checkout.
- **Payment Processing via Stripe:** Integration with Stripe allows secure and easy payment transactions.
- **Order Management:** Both buyers and sellers can view and track their orders.

The outcome of this project is a fully functioning e-commerce platform that ensures smooth transactions and provides an easy-to-use interface. The back-end handles dynamic content and user interactions efficiently, while the front-end, built with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, ensures intuitive and responsive user interface.

1.2 Relevance to Course Modules

This project is highly relevant to several BCS (Bachelor of Computer Science) course modules. These modules form the foundation for understanding the technologies and methodologies used throughout the project. The key modules covered by this project include:

- **Database Management:** This project utilizes MySQL for managing data such as user profiles, product listings, orders, and payments. Learning database concepts such as relational design, query optimization, and transaction management helped in building an efficient back-end structure.
- **Web Development:** The project's design and implementation closely align with web development concepts. The technologies used in this project — PHP, HTML, CSS, JavaScript — were learned in the web development module.
- **Software Engineering:** This module emphasizes the application of formal development processes. The structured approach to developing ReSellZone, from planning to implementation and testing, is based on these principles.
- **Security:** Secure payment gateways like Stripe were integrated to ensure transaction safety, aligning with best practices in cybersecurity, which was covered in this module.
- **Networking:** The project's use of network communication protocols ensures users' data and transactions are securely managed, aligning with what was learned in networking courses.

The project integrates these key areas, providing practical experience in building an e-commerce solution that applies concepts learned throughout the program.

1.3 Project Background

The idea behind the ReSellZone platform stems from the growing demand for online marketplaces where individuals and businesses can sell products to a wide customer base. While major platforms such as Amazon and eBay dominate the space, many smaller vendors struggle to establish their online presence due to high operational costs and complex interface designs.

ReSellZone aims to address this issue by providing a simple, low-cost platform for small and medium-sized businesses (SMBs) to sell their products online. The platform targets users from various categories, including tech products, clothing, and household goods. It is designed to cater to both novice and experienced users, ensuring accessibility and simplicity without compromising on essential e-commerce functionalities.

The platform's flexibility allows it to grow and adapt to various product categories and user needs. By enabling sellers to manage their listings and buyers to seamlessly browse and purchase products.

1.4 Literature Review

The literature review discusses existing trends in the e-commerce domain and provides an analysis of current technologies and approaches in online marketplaces. Some of the major topics covered include:

- **E-commerce Market Growth:** Online shopping has seen explosive growth over the last decade. As per studies, e-commerce sales are expected to continue increasing, with platforms like Amazon and Alibaba setting high standards for online marketplace functionality.
- **Stripe Payment Gateway:** Secure and reliable payment processing is crucial for any e-commerce platform. Research indicates that Stripe has become one of the most widely adopted payment solutions due to its ease of integration, strong security protocols, and user-friendly design.
- **User Interface (UI) and User Experience (UX):** The success of any e-commerce platform depends on its UI/UX design. Existing research shows that a clean, responsive design is essential for user retention. Features like easy navigation, quick checkout, and responsive mobile design are key contributors to the success of e-commerce websites.
- **Security in E-commerce:** As cyber-attacks become more sophisticated, security in e-commerce platforms is more critical than ever. Secure coding practices, SSL encryption, and the use of trusted payment processors like Stripe are necessary to protect user data and build trust with customers.

1.5 Analysis from Literature Review

By analyzing the current landscape of e-commerce platforms, several trends and insights were considered in the design of ReSellZone. While large-scale platforms like Amazon and eBay offer comprehensive solutions, smaller businesses often struggle with complex and expensive systems. ReSellZone addresses this gap by offering an easy-to-use platform that focuses on the core features necessary for both buyers and sellers. The literature review highlighted the importance of:

- **Simplicity in Design:** Many users prefer platforms with simple, clean interfaces that minimize cognitive load. ReSellZone has been designed to be intuitive, with minimalistic navigation that prioritizes ease of use.
- **Responsive Design:** Given the rise of mobile commerce, ensuring a responsive, mobile-friendly design was essential. This aspect of the project aligns with findings from the literature that highlight the importance of mobile-first development.
- **Integration of Secure Payment Systems:** Implementing Stripe for payment processing was a direct outcome of the analysis, ensuring both ease of payment and strong security protocols.

The table below discusses a feature-wise comparison between ReSellZone and established platforms such as OLX, Facebook Marketplace, Daraz, and Amazon. It highlights how ReSellZone addresses key limitations in usability, security, and user engagement identified through the literature review.

Table 1: Feature Comparison with Existing Platforms

Feature	ReSellZone (Our FYP Project)	OLX / Facebook Marketplace	Daraz / Amazon
User Authentication	Secure email-based authentication using Laravel Sanctum with proper verification flow	Basic (social logins, limited email verification)	Secure but business account dependent
Admin Control & Dashboard	Full-featured Admin Panel with moderation tools, user & product management	Minimal admin tools, limited backend access	Strong admin features, but for sellers/vendors
User-Based Product Listings	General users can list products easily with admin approval mechanism	Yes, but often lacks verification	Mainly supports business/vendor listings only
Live Chat / Communication	Real-time buyer-seller messaging system built with Laravel & Vue.js	FB Messenger / OLX chat	No direct chat (mostly through order systems)
Payment Integration	Integrated Stripe for online payments + Cash on Delivery (COD)	No integrated payments (manual transactions)	Full-fledged gateways, but no COD in all regions
Product Approval Workflow	All listings are verified by admin before public visibility	Listings go live instantly, often unverified	Verified but automated, mainly business-oriented
Category-Based Search & Filters	Advanced filtering by categories, price, location, and condition	Basic filters only	Extensive, but complex interface
User Interface (UI/UX)	Clean, responsive, mobile-friendly UI tailored for usability	Often cluttered or ad-heavy	Professional, but designed for e-commerce not resell
Security & Privacy	Encrypted communication, secure login, and user data protection practices	Low to moderate	Moderate to strong

1.6 Methodology and Software Lifecycle for This Project

This project follows an Agile methodology, which emphasizes flexibility and iterative progress. The project was broken down into manageable phases, with each phase involving planning, development, testing, and feedback. The development team conducted regular meetings to evaluate the progress and adapt to any changes in user requirements.

In the initial stages, the Waterfall model was used for gathering detailed requirements and designing the system architecture. Once the design phase was complete, the development and testing followed an Agile approach, allowing for continuous improvements and refinements based on user feedback.

1.6.1 Rationale Behind Selected Methodology

The Agile methodology was selected for this project due to its adaptability. Since the platform is intended to evolve over time based on user feedback and market trends, Agile allowed the team to make iterative improvements. The Waterfall model was used initially to establish a clear foundation for the system's requirements, ensuring the team understood the project's scope and objectives before jumping into development. By using a combination of Waterfall for planning and Agile for development, the project was able to stay on track while remaining flexible enough to incorporate feedback and improvements during the process.

Chapter 2: Problem Definition

2 Problem Definition

The rapid growth of the e-commerce sector has transformed how businesses operate, providing new opportunities for sales, outreach, and customer engagement. While large-scale enterprises and established vendors have benefited immensely from platforms like Amazon, eBay, and Daraz, small and medium-sized businesses (SMBs) and individual entrepreneurs often face substantial challenges in leveraging these platforms effectively.

Despite the increased accessibility of digital tools, there remains a significant gap in the market for affordable, easy-to-use, and scalable e-commerce solutions tailored specifically for smaller vendors. Existing platforms typically present the following issues:

- **High Entry Barriers:** The cost of listing, commission fees, and subscription models on major platforms can be prohibitive for small-scale sellers.
- **Complex Onboarding and Management:** Sellers often find it difficult to navigate platform policies, backend management systems, and setup procedures.
- **Limited Customization:** Most mainstream platforms offer restricted flexibility in design and branding, limiting the seller's ability to build a unique identity.
- **Technical Challenges:** Integrating secure payment gateways, managing inventory, and handling orders require technical expertise that many small business owners may not possess.
- **Scalability Concerns:** Many existing solutions do not scale well for vendors as their business grows, leading to inefficiencies or the need to migrate to new platforms.

These challenges often discourage small vendors from participating in the digital marketplace or lead to poor user experiences that hinder growth and sales. **Proposed Solution:** ReSellZone to address the above challenges, this project proposes the development of ReSellZone, a comprehensive e-commerce platform designed with the specific needs of SMBs and individual sellers in mind. The platform will aim to provide the following core solutions:

- **Ease of Use:** A simplified, intuitive interface for both buyers and sellers, reducing the learning curve and technical dependency.
- **Cost-Effectiveness:** Minimal or no platform fees to ensure affordability for smaller vendors and startup sellers.
- **Secure Payment Integration:** Support for reliable and secure payment gateways like Stripe to facilitate trustworthy transactions.
- **Scalability:** A system architecture that supports future growth and business expansion, allowing sellers to scale without changing platforms.
- **Customization & Flexibility:** Allowing sellers to personalize their storefronts, product listings, and communication with customers.

2.1 Expected Outcome

The outcome of this project will be the ReSellZone platform—a fully functional, secure, and scalable e-commerce solution that enables SMBs and individual sellers to establish, manage, and grow their online businesses with minimal

technical barriers. By offering a cost-effective and user-friendly alternative to existing complex platforms, ReSellZone will empower local entrepreneurs and contribute to the broader digital economy.

2.2 Problem Statement

The e-commerce industry has seen significant growth in recent years, with more businesses transitioning to online platforms to expand their reach. However, many small to medium-sized businesses (SMBs) and individuals still face barriers in creating an effective online marketplace. Existing platforms like Amazon and eBay are often too complex, expensive, or difficult for new sellers to navigate. These platforms require high operational costs, long onboarding times, and lack customization for smaller businesses.

The primary issue faced by smaller vendors is the lack of accessible, user-friendly, and affordable online selling platforms. These vendors often struggle with designing, managing, and scaling their businesses online, as they are overwhelmed by platform fees, limited design flexibility, and complex payment integrations. The problem to be solved by this project is the creation of a simple, scalable, and secure e-commerce platform that allows small and medium-sized businesses (SMBs) to sell their products easily. ReSellZone aims to address this problem by offering:

- A user-friendly platform that minimizes the complexity of setting up an online store.
- Affordability, by offering a free or low-cost platform for small businesses and individual sellers.
- Integration with secure payment gateways like Stripe to ensure safe and reliable transactions.
- A scalable solution, allowing vendors to easily expand their online presence as their business grows.

The outcome of solving this problem will be the ReSellZone platform, an e-commerce solution designed to enable SMBs and individuals to efficiently sell products online, with an emphasis on ease of use, flexibility, and security.

2.3 Deliverables

The key deliverables for this project are the following:

2.3.1 Functional Web Application

The core deliverable is a fully functional e-commerce website, ReSellZone, which includes the following features:

- User Registration and Authentication: Both buyers and sellers can create accounts, manage profiles, and log in securely.
- Product Listing System: Sellers can list their products with essential details like product name, description, price, and images.
- Search and Filter Capabilities: Buyers can search for products based on categories, keywords, or filters.

- **Shopping Cart and Checkout:** Buyers can add products to their cart, modify quantities, and proceed checkout.
- **Payment Integration:** Integration with Stripe ensures secure and reliable payments through credit/debit cards and other available payment methods.
- **Order Management System:** Both buyers and sellers can view and track orders, allowing easy management of sales and deliveries.

2.3.2 Database Design

A well-structured database designed to store and manage critical data such as user profiles, product listings, orders, payment transactions, and other necessary information.

2.4 Responsive Front-End Interface

A clean, intuitive, and mobile-friendly design that ensures a great user experience on both desktop and mobile devices.

2.4.1 Security Features

- **SSL Encryption** for secure communication between users and the website.
- **Secure Payment Gateway Integration:** Using Stripe to handle payments securely and efficiently.
- **User Authentication and Authorization:** Ensuring only registered users can access specific features based on roles (e.g., buyers or sellers).

2.4.2 Documentation

- **User Manual:** Instructions for users (buyers and sellers) on how to use the platform.
- **Developer Documentation:** Details for maintaining, updating, and extending the platform, including information on setting up the development environment, understanding the codebase, and adding new features.

2.4.3 Testing and Debugging

- **Unit Testing:** Ensuring that all components of the application work as expected.
- **Integration Testing:** Verifying that all system parts work seamlessly together.
- **User Acceptance Testing (UAT):** Ensuring the application meets user requirements and functions as intended.

2.5 Development Requirements

For the successful development of ReSellZone, the following requirements must be met:

2.5.1 Technical Requirements

The technical requirements outline the software tools, frameworks, and services essential for the development, deployment, and maintenance of the ReSellZone platform.

2.5.1.1 Web Development Frameworks

- Back-End: PHP (Laravel Framework)
- Database: MySQL
- Front-End: HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- Responsive Design: Bootstrap
- Payment Gateway: Stripe API for secure online transactions
- Version Control: Git for source code management
- Hosting: Apache or Nginx server with PHP and MySQL support

2.5.2 Functional Requirements

- The system should allow user registration and authentication, including email verification.
- The platform should enable product listings with details such as name, price, description, and images.
- Buyers must be able to search for products and add them to their cart.
- The system must support secure payments, preferably using Stripe integration.
- Sellers should be able to manage their orders and track sales performance.
- The system must ensure robust security, including SSL encryption, password hashing, and payment tokenization.
- There should be an admin panel for managing users, products, and overall platform activity.
- The platform should provide notifications or emails to users about important updates like order status or account changes.

2.5.3 Non-Functional Requirements

- Usability: The platform should be intuitive and easy to use for both buyers and sellers.
- Scalability: The system must be designed to handle growth, including an increasing number of users and products.
- Performance: The platform must have fast load times, with optimized front-end and back-end performance.
- Reliability: The system must have high uptime, with minimal downtime during maintenance or updates.
- Security: Strong encryption and secure payment processes to protect sensitive data and transactions.

2.5.4 Human Resources

- **Project Manager:** Oversees the project, ensuring timelines are met and resources are allocated effectively.
- **Back-End Developer:** Focuses on developing the back-end functionalities, including user authentication, payment processing, and database management.
- **Front-End Developer:** Responsible for designing and developing the user interface, ensuring it is responsive and user-friendly.
- **Database Administrator:** Manages the design and optimization of the database, ensuring efficient data storage and retrieval.
- **Quality Assurance (QA) Specialist:** Tests the application for bugs and ensures it meets all requirements before deployment.

2.5.5 Time Requirements

The project is expected to take approximately 6-8 months to complete, divided into various phases such as planning, development, testing, and deployment.

2.6 Methodology Used

For the development of ReSellZone, the Agile Methodology was chosen. Agile allows for flexibility, iterative development, and frequent feedback, making it suitable for the dynamic nature of the e-commerce platform. This methodology ensures continuous delivery of working software, regular evaluation, and the ability to adapt to changes as the project evolves.

2.6.1 Why Agile Methodology?

The Agile approach is particularly beneficial for ReSellZone due to the following reasons:

- **Iterative Development:** Agile iterative nature allows for quick development cycles (sprints) that focus on delivering functional increments of the application. This ensures early validation and feedback from stakeholders, minimizing the risk of project failure.
- **Adaptability to Change:** As requirements for ReSellZone may evolve during development, Agile allows for adjustments based on market demands, user feedback, and new technological trends.
- **Collaboration and Communication:** Frequent communication and collaboration between developers, stakeholders, and customers is emphasized in Agile, ensuring that the platform meets business needs and expectations.

- Continuous Improvement: Agile focuses on continuous improvements based on feedback, allowing the project to evolve incrementally. Each sprint results in an enhanced version of the platform.

2.6.2 Scrum Framework

The project follows the Scrum framework, which is a subset of Agile that is ideal for projects with changing requirements. Scrum provides a structured approach, focusing on roles, events, and artifacts to guide the development process.

2.6.2.1 Scrum Roles

- Product Owner: The Product Owner represents the customer or business and is responsible for defining the features, functionalities, and priorities in the Product Backlog. They work closely with the development team to ensure the product meets business goals.
- Scrum Master: The Scrum Master facilitates Scrum practices, removes obstacles, and ensures that the development team adheres to the Scrum framework. They are also responsible for organizing and facilitating Scrum events.
- Development Team: The development team is responsible for executing the tasks in the Sprint Backlog. They are cross-functional, meaning they have the necessary skills to develop, test, and deploy the product incrementally.

2.6.2.2 Scrum Artifacts

- Product Backlog: The Product Backlog is a prioritized list of features, user stories, enhancements, and bug fixes that need to be addressed in the project. The Product Owner continuously updates the Product Backlog based on evolving business needs and feedback from stakeholders.
- Sprint Backlog: The Sprint Backlog is a list of tasks that the development team commits to complete within a sprint. It is created during Sprint Planning and guides the team throughout the sprint.
- Increment: The Increment is the working product or feature set those results from completing tasks in the Sprint Backlog. At the end of each sprint, the Increment is a usable and potentially shippable version of the platform.

2.6.2.3 Scrum Events

- Sprint Planning: This event marks the beginning of each sprint. During Sprint Planning, the development team and Product Owner discuss the tasks to be worked on, define goals, and set priorities for the upcoming sprint.
- Daily Stand-up: A short, daily meeting where the development team discusses their progress, identifies

obstacles, and plans for the next 24 hours. This ensures that the team stays aligned and focused.

- **Sprint Review:** At the end of each sprint, the development team and stakeholders review the work completed, demonstrate the Increment, and gather feedback for the next sprint.
- **Sprint Retrospective:** After the Sprint Review, the team reflects on the sprint and discusses what went well, what could be improved, and how to enhance the process for the next sprint.

2.6.3 Other Methodologies Used

While Agile and Scrum serve as the primary methodologies for the development of ReSellZone, several supporting practices were employed to ensure smooth execution.

2.6.3.1 DevOps Practices

Continuous Integration and Continuous Deployment (CI/CD): A CI/CD pipeline was set up to automate the integration and deployment of code. This practice ensured that new code was continuously tested and deployed to production, reducing manual errors and speeding up the development process.

2.6.3.2 User-Centered Design (UCD)

Focus on User Experience (UX): The design of ReSellZone focused heavily on user-centered design principles, ensuring the platform is intuitive, responsive, and easy to use. Regular usability testing and user feedback sessions were integrated into the development cycle to refine the user interface.

2.6.3.3 Rationale Behind the Chosen Methodology

The Agile methodology, specifically Scrum, was selected due to its iterative nature, which aligns with the need for frequent updates and responsiveness to changing requirements. ReSellZone needed a flexible and adaptive approach to handle evolving user needs and ensure continuous delivery of functional features. By using Agile and Scrum, the project could be developed in manageable sprints, ensuring the system remained aligned with both business goals and user requirements. Additionally, the use of DevOps and UCD practices ensured that the product was both technically robust and user-friendly.



Figure 1:Agile Methodology

2.7 Current System

Currently, the landscape of e-commerce platforms is dominated by a variety of established solutions such as Amazon, eBay, Shopify, and Etsy. These platforms are highly functional but come with their own set of limitations that make them less ideal for small and medium-sized businesses (SMBs) or individual sellers. The existing systems in use today include:

2.7.1 Amazon and eBay

- These are two of the largest e-commerce platforms globally, allowing businesses to list products and sell them to a massive audience. However, both platforms are oversaturated, and it is often difficult for new or small vendors to stand out without significant marketing efforts.
- Sellers must adhere to strict guidelines, and the fees on each sale can be quite high, reducing profitability for smaller vendors.
- There is limited customization for storefronts, making it difficult for sellers to create a unique branding experience for their products.
- Customer relationships are controlled by the platform, meaning sellers have limited access to buyer data, making it difficult to build long-term customer loyalty or direct communication channels.

2.7.2 Shopify

- Shopify is a popular platform for building custom online stores, but it often requires a monthly subscription fee, along with additional fees for premium features or third-party apps.
- The platform offers extensive customization but at the cost of time and expertise. Small businesses that do not have in-house developers may struggle to fully customize their stores.
- Despite its popularity, Shopify can be cost-prohibitive for very small businesses or individual sellers who have limited budgets.

2.7.3 Etsy

- Etsy is a platform focused on handmade and vintage products. While it is excellent for these categories, it lacks the features needed for broader e-commerce, especially for businesses wanting to sell a wider range of products.
- Etsy's marketplace can also be highly competitive, and again, fees on each transaction reduce sellers' profitability.
- Sellers on Etsy have limited control over their storefront designs and overall branding.

2.8 Limitations of Current Systems:

While the systems mentioned above are effective for large and established vendors, they pose significant barriers for smaller or independent sellers, such as:

- **High Transaction Fees:** Platforms like Amazon and eBay charge significant fees on sales, which reduces profit margins for sellers.
- **Complexity:** Many existing platforms are complicated to navigate, requiring extensive setup time and technical knowledge for things like customization, payment integration, and order management.
- **Limited Control:** Sellers often have little to no control over the user experience, limiting their ability to brand their stores or differentiate themselves from competitors.
- **Over-Saturation:** Large platforms like Amazon are highly competitive, making it hard for small businesses to gain visibility among millions of sellers.
- **Scalability Issues:** Many smaller platforms are not designed with scalability in mind. As businesses grow, they may find that the platforms they started on can no longer support their needs efficiently.

2.9 How ReSellZone Improves Upon the Current Systems

ReSellZone seeks to address the limitations of existing platforms by providing a simpler, more affordable,

customizable, and scalable solution for small to medium-sized businesses. By offering:

- **Low or No Fees:** Unlike platforms that charge high transaction fees, ReSellZone provides a cost-effective solution for SMBs, ensuring that sellers retain more of their profits.
- **Ease of Use:** The platform is designed to be user-friendly, even for sellers with limited technical expertise. With a drag-and-drop interface and easy-to-follow setup processes, sellers can quickly establish their online stores.
- **Customizability:** ReSellZone allows vendors to create fully customizable stores, enabling them to have unique branding and product displays that stand out from the competition.
- **Scalability:** As businesses grow, ReSellZone can scale to meet their needs, supporting a larger product inventory, increased sales, and more complex business processes without sacrificing performance.

In essence, **ReSellZone** seeks to bridge the gap between large, complex e-commerce systems and small vendors who need a simple, effective, and cost-efficient solution to sell their products online.

Chapter 3: Requirement Analysis

3 Requirement Analysis

3.1 Use Cases Diagram

The Use Cases Diagram illustrates the dynamic interactions between different user roles and the ReSellZone e-commerce system. It provides a high-level overview of how users engage with the system's functionality and outlines the specific tasks each role is authorized to perform. The diagram categorizes the system users into three primary roles: Buyers, Sellers, and Admins, each having distinct access rights and responsibilities within the platform.

3.1.1 Roles:

- Buyers: Individuals who visit the platform to browse, select, and purchase products.
- Sellers: Vendors who register to list their products and manage customer interactions.
- Admins: System operators responsible for platform governance and moderation.

3.1.2 Use Cases:

- Buyer: Browse products, search by category or filter, add items to cart, make secure payments, and view past order history.
- Seller: Register new products, upload images and descriptions, manage incoming orders, monitor sales performance, and respond to buyer inquiries.
- Admin: Approve or reject product listings, manage user accounts, monitor platform usage, handle disputes, and ensure policy compliance.

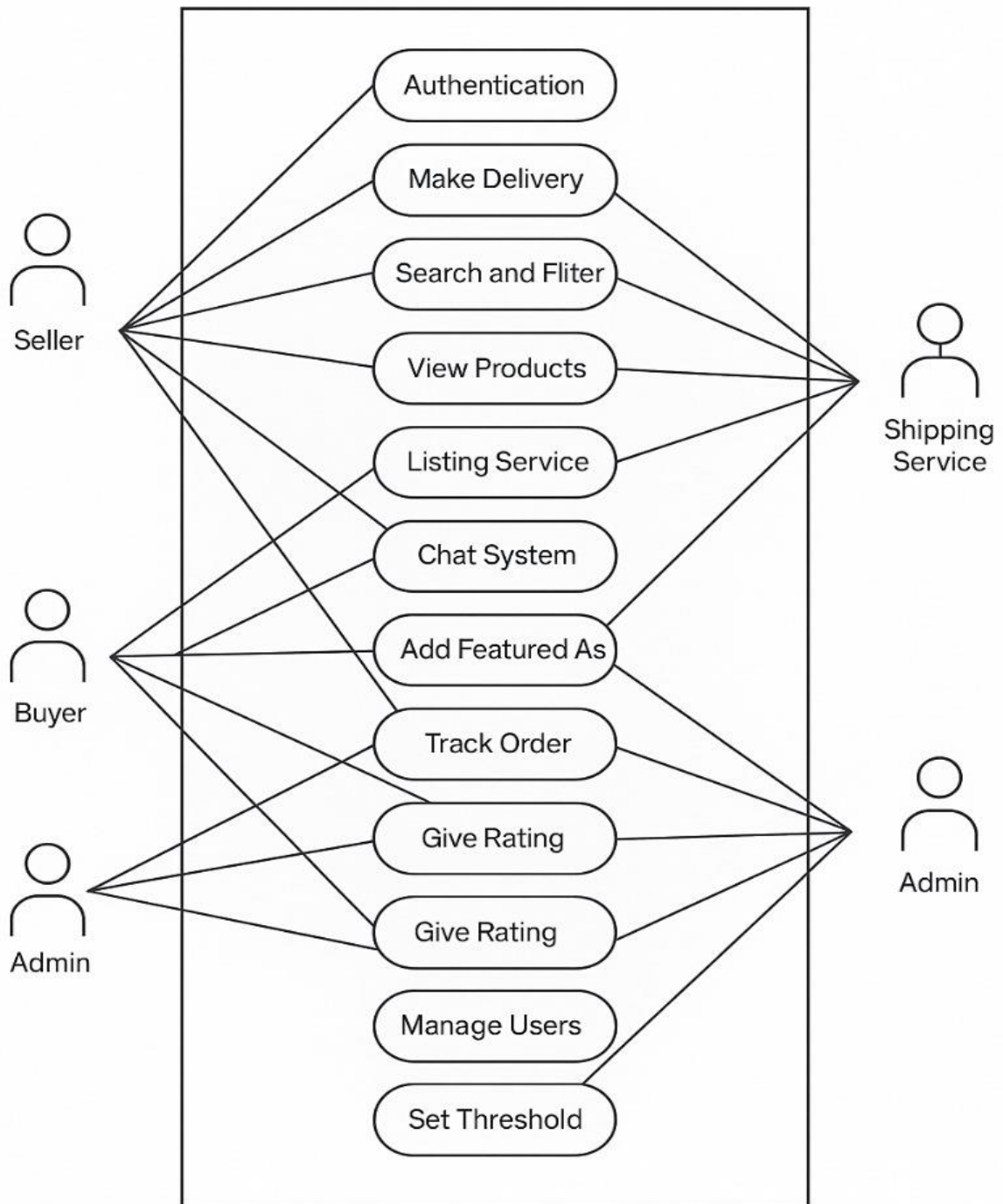


Figure 2: Use Case Diagram

3.2 Detailed Use Case

This section elaborates on the detailed use cases that define the system's specific operations.

Table 2: Use Case (Admin Login)

Use case ID	01
Use case name	Login
Actors	Admin User
Description	A user of the System logs into the System.
Trigger	User requests to log in.
Pre-condition	The user has an account.
Post-Condition	The actor is now logged into the system.
Normal flow	- Use case starts when an actor wants to login. - System asks for email/phone and password. - Actor enters credentials. - System validates and logs in.
Alternative flow	- Valid email/phone or invalid password. - If invalid, system shows an error message.
Exceptions	- Incorrect credentials. - Request to re-enter login details.
Business rules	The system must be connected to the network.

Table 3: Use Case 02 (User Registration)

Use case id count.	02
Use case name	Get Registration
Roles	• Customer (Buyer/Seller) • Admin
Description	A user of the System creates an ac
Trigger	Select the register link
Pre-condition	When the user doesn't have an account to log in to the system.
Normal flow	This use case starts when the user is not logged in to the system and goes to the login page. The system prompts the user to send an e-mail and password or register a new account. User selects the registration option. The system displays the signup page that allows users to fill in their username/email address, first and last name, and password. The user enters their information. System verifies information and creates an account.
Alternative flow	Cancel Registration The users select the cancel option. The system returns the user to the home page without the

	user being logged in and any information entered has been erased. Invalid Information Entered Users can enter information and submit it. System displays a message to correct invalid information. The user re-enters the information.
Exceptions	If an existing user exists, then a "User already exists" message is displayed. If information is missing "Insufficient Information" message is Displayed.
Business rules	Active internet access is available.

Table 4: Use Case 03 (Viewing Products/Ads)

Use case ID	03
Use case name	View Ads
Actors	• Customer
Description	Customers can view the entire available product and select the product of their choice.
Trigger	Users can view the ads/product on the E-shop section.
Pre-condition	The actors log in to the system.
Post-condition	The customer sees the information related to the particular product/ads and selects the product of their own choice.
Normal flow	The users log in to the system. View the product.
Alternative flow	The user did not register but can still view, with no other functions.
Exceptions	The error occurs in the application. Server is down.
Business rules	User registration is required.

Table 5: Use Case 04 (Buyer-Seller Communication)

Use case ID	04
Use case name	Conversation
Actors	Customer (both Sale and purchase)
Description	This use case describes the process by which a customer views an advertisement on the platform and initiates a conversation regarding the ad.
Trigger	The customer views an ad and messages on the selected ad of their choice to get more details (Number, Message, Call).
Pre-condition	- Customers want to purchase from ads posted. - Customers must get registered on the website.
Post-condition	
Normal flow	- The customer must provide his/her details (like phone number) to access other details. - The customer successfully logs in to the system. - Customers successfully get registered.
Alternative flow	- Admin does not accept the request. - No product against his/her search.
Exceptions	
Business rules	- There is no internet. - Server down. - Message should be respectful. - Both parties must decide a safe method of communication.

Table 6: Customer and Admin Communication

Feature/Action	Customer	Admin
Registration	Customers must register to post or buy ads.	Admin must register to manage the platform.
Login	Logs in to access platform features such as posting ads and buying products.	Logs in to oversee platform activities and manage user content.
Posting Ads	Can post ads with title, image, and price.	Does not post ads but approves/rejects ads for quality and compliance.
Buying Products	Can browse and buy products listed on the platform.	Does not engage in buying but ensures smooth functionality of the buying process.
Managing Users	Does not manage other users.	Can ban/unban users and take actions against those violating platform rules.
Approval of Ads	Ads are automatically submitted for review.	Reviews, approves, or rejects ads based on platform rules and policies.
Handling Messages	Can receive and send messages regarding product inquiries.	Does not engage in direct communication with customers about products.
Access Rights	Limited to features necessary for buying and selling products.	Has full control over all platform operations, including content moderation.
Error Handling	Can report errors such as login failures, server issues, or application errors.	Investigates and resolves reported issues.
Business Rules Enforcement	Must provide real and accurate details for product listings; violations may result in account suspension.	Enforces business rules and monitors compliance.

Table 7: Checkout Buyer

Attribute	Details
Use Case Name	Checkout
Role	Buyer
Description	Allows a buyer to purchase products by proceeding through the checkout process.
Pre-condition	Buyer is logged in.- Items are in the cart.
Post-condition	An order is created. Buyer receives a confirmation.

Table 8: Product Listing (Seller)

Attribute	Details
Use Case Name	Product Listing (Seller)
Role	Seller
Description	Enables a seller to add a new product by providing its name, description, price, and images.
Pre-condition	Seller must be logged in.
Post-condition	Product is stored and listed for buyers to view Admin approval (if applicable) may be pending.

Table9 : Use Case 05 (Product Purchase from E-shop)

Use case ID	05
Use case name	E-shop Purchase
Actors	Admin Buyer
Description	Customers can view the product.
Trigger	Users want to see product details and price.
Pre-condition	The actors log in to the system.
Post-condition	
Normal flow	The customer needs to enter their phone number and address to order. The users log in to the system.
Alternative flow	The user has not registered and has not viewed the available prices. Customer can also give reviews.
Exceptions	The error occurs in the application. The server is down.
Business rules	User registration is required.

Table 10: Use Case 06 (Payment Processing via COD or Bank Transfer)

Use case ID	06
Use case name	Payment
Actors	Customer (buyer)• Seller/buyer
Description	The Buyer, after buying the product, needs to fill out a payment form. Currently, it will support two options: COD and specific bank account.
Trigger	Customers want to confirm payment. Admin (Seller) manages payments.
Pre-condition	The customer must be registered and have access to their user account.
Post-condition	The customer can view the updated payment for their product and receives confirmation emails. Admin (Seller) updates the customer table.
Normal flow	- The customer successfully logs in to the system. The customer successfully confirms payment.
Alternative flow	The customer does not log in has not access to the user account.
Exceptions	There is no internet. The error occurs in the application. Server down.
Business rules	The customer only confirms payments after signing agreements.

Table 11: Use Case 07 (Posting Product Ads by Registered Customers)

Use case ID	07
Use case name	Posting Ads
Actors	Customer Seller buyer
Description	Customer can post as well as buy from this platform.
Trigger	Customer wants to post their ad to sell their product.
Pre-condition	The customer must be registered Admin must be registered.
Post-condition	Seller can receive messages Seller may ask to share address and number.
Normal flow	- The customer successfully logs in to the system. He/She posts their ad and its details (Title, Image, Price).
Alternative flow	No Alternative Flow.
Exceptions	- There is no internet. The error occurs in the application. Server down.
Business rules	The post must be updated with real details free of scams a user may get banned if they try to scam.

Table 12: Use Case 08 (Posting and Managing E-shop Product Ads)

Use case ID	08
Use case name	Product Ads
Actors	Seller Buyer
Description	The registered E-shop seller can post different ads while providing online delivery.
Trigger	Customer (buyer) wants to buy brand new products.
Pre-condition	The seller must register their E-shop.
Post-condition	The seller must verify the order and foresee the payment method.
Normal flow	- The customer successfully logs in to the system Posts their product. Tracks the order and delivery.
Alternative flow	- The seller can save the product in draft. The product may be put onto sale.
Exceptions	- There is no internet. The error occurs in the website. Server down.
Business rules	The seller must ensure the order details.

Table 13: Use Case 09 (Admin Management of Customer Details)

Use case ID	09
Use case name	Manage Details
Actors	Admin Customer
Description	Admin can view all data of the customer and manage their details (Delete, update, or put restrictions).
Trigger	Admin wants to track user activity.
Pre-condition	The admin received the details of the customers and their products. The admin tracks progress and activities.
Post-condition	Admin can save user info and send updates if required.
Normal flow	- Admin successfully manages customer information. - Customer sends all their details.
Alternative flow	Admin does not manage customer information. Customer didn't share their information.
Exceptions	- There is no internet. - An error occurs in the application. - Server down.
Business rules	Admin manages all customer details in proper sequence.

Table 14: Use Case 010 (Edit Profile Information)

Use case ID	010
Use case name	Edit Profile
Actors	Admin Seller Buyer
Description	After signing in, the customer/admin may make changes to their profile, including profile picture, address, phone number, or email.
Trigger	User wants to update their profile.
Pre-condition	User should be logged in. They should provide relevant information to the relevant field.
Post-condition	Changes will be carried and updated into the database.
Normal flow	- User signs in to their profile. - Updates profile accordingly.
Alternative flow	No Alternative Flow.
Exceptions	- There is no internet. - The error occurs in the application. - Server down.
Business rules	- Admin manages all the drivers in proper sequence. - Both user and admin can update their profile settings.

3.3 Functional Requirements

3.3.1 User Accounts and Authentication

3.3.1.1 User Sign-Up and Account Creation

New users can register on the ReSellZone platform by creating an account using their email address and setting a secure password. For enhanced convenience and security, the platform also supports **Google Sign-In**, allowing users to quickly sign up without filling out lengthy registration forms. This streamlined onboarding process ensures quick access to the platform's features while maintaining user data integrity.

3.3.1.2 User Authentication and Login Access

Once registered, users can log in securely using their email and password credentials. The login system grants authenticated users access to essential features, including browsing product listings, posting ads, managing sales or purchases, and updating personal account settings. Robust authentication measures are implemented to ensure that user sessions remain protected and private.

3.3.1.3 Password Recovery and Account Security

In case users forget their password, the platform provides a password recovery mechanism. A secure reset link is sent to the user's registered email address, enabling them to create a new password and regain access to their account. This feature is designed to uphold account security while offering a simple and efficient way to resolve login issues.

3.3.2 Listing Products for Sale

3.3.2.1 Create a Product Listing

Sellers on ReSellZone can post items for sale through a guided and user-friendly listing process. Each listing requires essential product details to ensure clarity and attract potential buyers. Sellers are prompted to provide the product title, a detailed description, and high-quality images (up to a specified limit) to showcase the item effectively. Additional required information includes the price, item condition (new or used), appropriate category selection, and contact details for buyer inquiries. This structured approach ensures consistency across listings and improves the buyer experience.

3.3.2.2 Comprehensive Product Categorization

To facilitate efficient product discovery and improve user navigation, ReSellZone allows sellers to categorize their listings under relevant predefined categories. Categorization helps streamline searches and enhance platform usability. Key categories include:

- **Vehicles** Cars, motorcycles, and related automotive accessories
- **Mobiles** Smartphones, tablets, and mobile accessories
- **Furniture** Home, office, and customized furniture options
- **Jobs** Job listings for seekers and opportunities from employers
- **Sports** Equipment and gear for various sports and outdoor activities
- **Property** Residential and commercial properties for sale or rent
- **Rent** Tools, equipment, or spaces available for temporary rental
- **Healthcare** – Health-related products, wellness items, and fitness gear
- **Animals & Birds** – Pets, farm animals, birds, and related supplies
- **More** – Miscellaneous categories covering diverse user needs

This robust categorization ensures better organization and helps both buyers and sellers find what they need quickly and efficiently.

3.3.2.3 Admin Review and Content Moderation (Optional)

To maintain platform integrity, product listings may be subjected to an **admin review process**. During this process, administrators verify listings for accuracy, quality, and compliance with Resell Zone's content policies. This optional moderation feature helps filter out inappropriate content, fraudulent ads, or policy violations, thereby building trust among users and maintaining a high standard of quality.

3.3.2.4 Manage and Update Listings

Sellers retain full control over their posted ads through the Manage Listings feature within their account dashboard. They can edit listing details, update prices or images, or remove products once sold or no longer available. This functionality ensures sellers can keep their listings accurate, up to date, and aligned with current availability, thereby improving customer satisfaction and seller credibility.

3.3.3 Browsing and Buying Products

3.3.3.1 Browse Listings by Category

ReSellZone provides an intuitive browsing experience by allowing buyers to explore products through clearly defined categories. This category-based navigation simplifies the search process, helping users quickly locate items of interest across diverse domains such as vehicles, electronics, furniture, jobs, and more. Each category is structured for clarity, ensuring that buyers can easily find relevant listings without unnecessary complexity.

3.3.3.2 Advanced Search and Filter Options

To enhance user experience and ensure efficient product discovery, ReSellZone includes a robust advanced search system. Buyers can refine their search results using multiple filters, including:

- **Price Range:** Set minimum and maximum price limits to match budget preferences.
- **Location:** Filter listings based on city, region, or area within Pakistan for localized results.
- **Item Condition:** Choose between new or used items, depending on personal preference or price considerations.

These filters allow users to tailor their searches to their specific needs, improving accuracy or reducing browsing time.

3.3.3.3 Direct Seller Contact and Communication

ReSellZone facilitates transparent communication by enabling buyers to directly contact sellers through the platform. Buyers can inquire about product details, negotiate pricing, or confirm availability before making a purchase. This direct communication fosters trust between users and encourages smoother transactions.

3.3.3.4 Save Listings for Later Viewing

Buyers have the option to bookmark or save favorite listings for future reference. This feature is particularly useful

for users who are comparing multiple products or not ready to make an immediate purchase. Saved listings are easily accessible from the user's profile, allowing for quick return visits and better decision-making.

3.3.4 Admin Panel and Backend Management

3.3.4.1 Comprehensive User Management System

ReSellZone implements a robust User Management Module that empowers administrators to monitor, regulate, and maintain the integrity of user activities across the platform. Admins play a critical role in ensuring platform safety, trust, and compliance by overseeing both buyer and seller accounts.

Key functionalities include:

- **Account Oversight:** Admins can access and manage a full list of registered users, view their activity logs, and update or disable accounts if required.
- **Suspension and Banning:** Users found engaging in fraudulent, abusive, or policy-violating behavior may have their accounts temporarily suspended or permanently deactivated.
- **Policy Enforcement:** Admins actively respond to reports submitted by users and investigate misconduct to uphold platform standards.
- **Seller Verification:** A verification mechanism may be used to confirm seller identities, enhancing buyer confidence and reducing scams.

3.3.4.2 Listing Monitoring and Moderation

The Listing Management System equips admins with full control over the content displayed on ReSellZone. All product listings submitted by sellers are subject to review to ensure they meet and policy standards. Core functions include:

- **Review and Approval:** Listings are evaluated for accuracy, completeness, and compliance before being made public.
- **Content Moderation:** Admins can update, request revisions, or remove listings that contain misleading or prohibited content.
- **Real-Time Monitoring:** Listings are monitored continuously to detect and respond to violations, spam, or duplicate posts.
- **Trust and Quality Assurance:** These practices ensure a consistent and trustworthy user experience for all buyers.

3.3.4.3 Customer Support and Communication Oversight

ReSellZone offers tools for admins to effectively manage communication channels and user engagement, including:

- **Query Handling:** Admins respond to user-submitted contact forms, feedback, and issue reports in a timely and organized manner.

- **Newsletter Management:** Admins manage subscription lists, schedule newsletters, and broadcast important updates or promotions to users.

3.3.4.4 Content and Access Control

Platform administrators maintain key content areas and manage user permissions through:

- **Content Editing:** Admins can update legal pages such as FAQs, Privacy Policies, and Terms & Conditions to reflect the latest platform guidelines.
- **Role-Based Access Control:** The system supports multiple user roles—admin, seller, and buyer—each with designated permissions and access levels for secure operations.

3.3.4.5 Order and Transaction Oversight

The platform includes tools to track and manage orders, providing transparency and security throughout the transaction lifecycle:

- **Order Tracking:** Admins can view transaction histories, monitor ongoing orders, and verify payment statuses.
- **Delivery Management:** Integration with sellers and logistics ensures smooth and timely delivery processes.
- **Dispute Resolution:** Admins may intervene in cases of delivery failures, fraud claims, or refund requests to resolve conflicts efficiently.

3.3.5 Help and Customer Support

3.3.5.1 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

ReSellZone features a comprehensive FAQs section designed to assist users with quick answers to the most commonly asked questions regarding platform usage. This section covers topics like account registration, product listings, payments, order tracking, and safety guidelines. It aims to reduce support requests by offering instant clarity on routine queries. The FAQs are regularly updated based on user feedback and evolving platform features, ensuring relevance and helpfulness. By providing self-service support, the platform enhances user convenience and experience.

3.3.5.2 Contact Us Form

The Contact Us form enables users to easily reach out to the ReSellZone support team for any questions, concerns, or suggestions. Users can fill in their name, email, subject, and message to initiate communication. The form is integrated with email routing to ensure timely responses from the appropriate department. It is especially useful for handling account issues, partnership inquiries, and technical assistance. All inquiries are tracked and managed for accountability and service improvement.

3.3.5.3 Terms & Conditions and Privacy Policy

ReSellZone includes clearly outlined Terms and Conditions and a detailed Privacy Policy to define the rules, rights, and responsibilities for platform users. The Terms and Conditions document covers usage rules, prohibited conduct, dispute resolution, and liability limitations. The Privacy Policy outlines how user data is collected, stored, protected,

and shared, ensuring transparency and compliance with data protection laws. Both documents are accessible from the website footer and are periodically updated to align with legal and operational changes. Acceptance of these policies is mandatory upon registration, promoting a safe and lawful environment for all.

3.4 Non-Functional Requirements

3.4.1 Usability

The platform is designed with a user-centric approach, prioritizing ease of use and accessibility. It features an intuitive and responsive interface that adapts seamlessly to desktops, tablets, and mobile devices. Users can quickly familiarize themselves with the layout due to its clean design and straightforward navigation, minimizing the learning curve. Whether a novice or a tech-savvy user, all individuals can engage with the system efficiently and confidently.

3.4.2 Performance

Optimized for high performance, the system processes user requests swiftly and delivers accurate, real-time responses. Backend operations are fine-tuned to reduce latency and maximize throughput, ensuring the platform remains responsive even under heavy load. This guarantees a seamless experience for users, particularly during peak usage periods or concurrent access by multiple users.

3.4.3 Security

The platform employs a comprehensive security framework to safeguard user data and system integrity. Access to sensitive features and data is restricted to authenticated users through secure login protocols. Role-based access control (RBAC) ensures that only authorized individuals can create, modify, or delete content. Advanced protection mechanisms—including encryption, input validation, and firewall defenses—are implemented to prevent unauthorized access, data breaches, and malicious attacks.

3.4.4 Portability

Built with cross-platform compatibility in mind, the application operates smoothly on Windows, macOS, and Linux operating systems. It supports all modern web browsers and provides a fully responsive design for optimal performance on smartphones and tablets. The platform is accessible via Android and iOS devices, enabling users to interact with its features effortlessly across multiple environments and devices.

3.4.5 Reliability

Reliability is a cornerstone of the system's architecture. Hosted on a secure, high-performance server infrastructure, the platform is capable of handling simultaneous user sessions without degradation in service quality. Regular system monitoring, fault tolerance mechanisms, and failover strategies contribute to the platform's ability to deliver uninterrupted service and maintain user trust.

Chapter 4: Design and Architecture

4 Design and Architecture

This chapter outlines the Design and Architecture for the ReSellZone platform, covering the system's architecture, data representation, process flow, and design models. These elements provide a comprehensive understanding of how the system is structured and how it operates. The goal is to ensure that the platform is scalable, secure, and performs well under different operational conditions.

4.1 System Architecture

The architecture of ReSellZone follows a modular and layered approach, which allows the platform to be flexible, maintainable, and scalable. The system is divided into three primary layers:

4.1.1 Presentation Layer:

The Presentation Layer is responsible for the user interface (UI) of ReSellZone. It is built using responsive web technologies such as HTML, CSS 3, Bootstrap 5, and JavaScript frameworks. This ensures that the platform is accessible across various devices, including desktops, tablets, and mobile phones. The goal is to offer a seamless and user-friendly experience for both buyers and sellers.

4.1.2 Application Layer:

The Application Layer is responsible for the business logic of the platform. It is developed using server-side technologies (e.g., PHP, JavaScript/Node.js). This layer handles user authentication, product listings, search functionality, order processing, and payment integration. It also manages user roles (buyer, seller, admin), ad posting, and the overall E-shop functionality. This layer is where most of the core functionalities of ReSellZone are implemented.

4.1.3 Database Layer:

The Database Layer uses a relational database (e.g., MySQL) to store crucial data such as user profiles, product listings, transaction records, and order histories. The data is securely stored, ensuring that sensitive information like payment details and personal data is protected. The database also supports the dynamic nature of the platform, allowing sellers to manage their products and buyers to place orders efficiently.

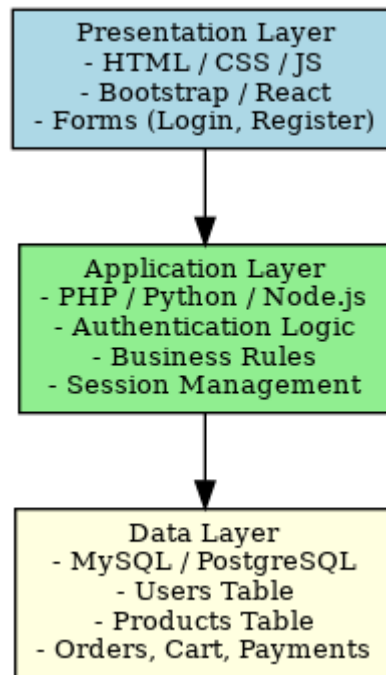


Figure 3: System Architecture

4.2 Data Representation

The data representation describes how the data is structured and stored within the system. It includes both diagrammatic and descriptive representations of how the data is managed across the platform.

Data Representation of ReSellZone

- **Users Table:** Contains information about users, including name, email, password (hashed), role (buyer/seller/admin), etc.
- **Products Table:** Stores details about the products listed by sellers, such as product name, description etc.
- **Orders Table:** Holds the data regarding orders placed by buyers, including order ID, buyer ID, product ID, payment status, and shipping details.
- **Payments Table:** Tracks payment details, including transaction ID, payment method (e.g., Stripe), and payment status.

The data representation in the ReSellZone platform is designed for efficient querying and management of product and user data. This ensures that the platform can handle complex queries such as searching for products, checking order history, and generating reports for sellers.

4.3 Process Flow/Representation

The Process Flow of ReSellZone describes how the different components of the system interact during typical use cases such as user registration, product listing, and order processing.

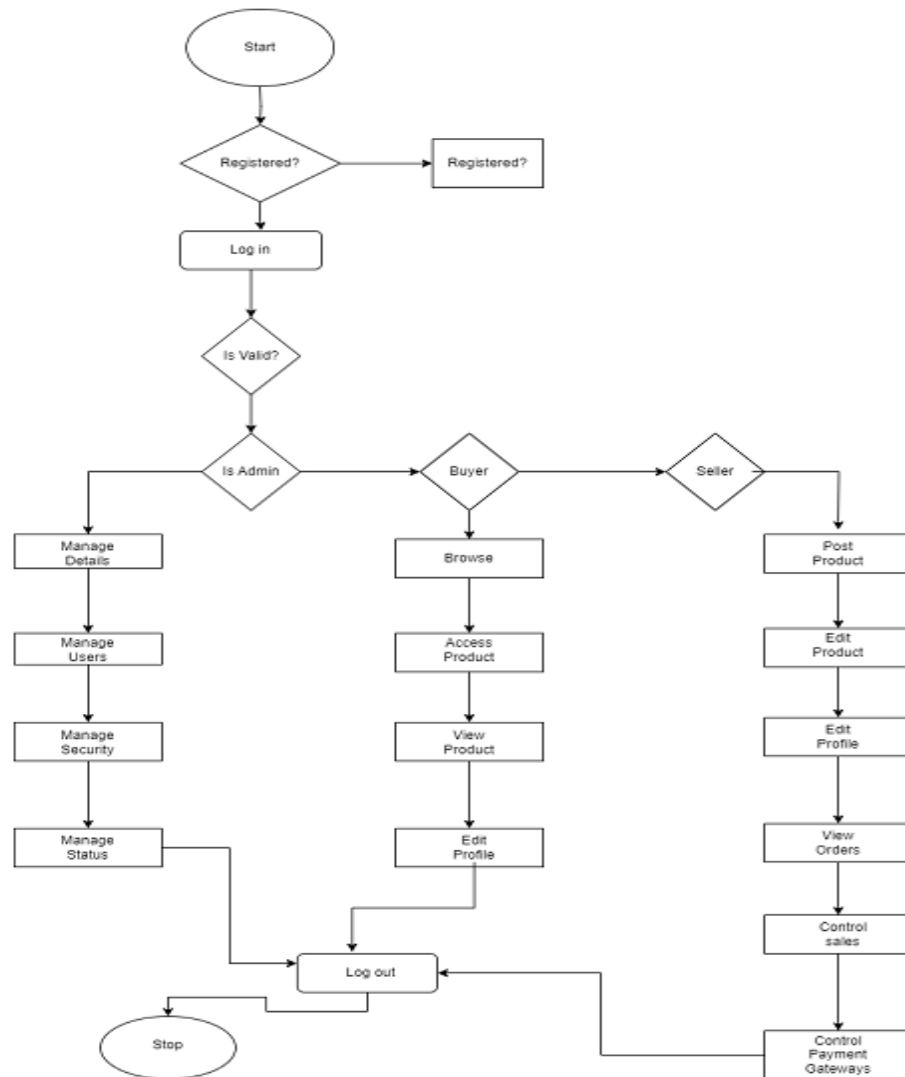


Figure 4: Process Flow Diagram

- User Registration: A user (either buyer or seller) accesses the registration page, submits their details, and the system stores them in the database.
- Product Listing: Sellers log in, add products to the platform by providing necessary details such as product name, description, and price.
- Browsing and Searching: Buyers browse products using search and filter functionalities to find products they are interested in.
- Checkout and Payment: After adding products to the cart, the buyer proceeds to checkout, enters payment details, and the system processes the payment via Stripe.
- Order Confirmation: Once the payment is successful, the system confirms the order and notifies both the buyer and the seller about the transaction.

- **Admin Review:** The Admin manages user accounts, approves/rejects product listings, and oversees platform activities to ensure smooth operation.

This flow ensures that the platform operates smoothly and allows both buyers and sellers to engage in transactions with minimal friction.

4.4 Design Models

Design models are important to provide a clear and comprehensive understanding of how the system is structured and how its components interact. The following design models illustrate key aspects of the **ReSellZone** platform's architecture and functionality:

4.4.1 User Interface Design Model

This design model shows the different pages of the platform, including the landing page, registration/login pages, product listing page, product detail page, cart page, and checkout page. These pages are linked through a navigation bar and responsive design.

4.4.2 Class Diagram (for Object-Oriented Design)

The Class Diagram represents the object-oriented structure of the platform. It shows the various classes such as User, Product, Order, and Payment and their interactions.

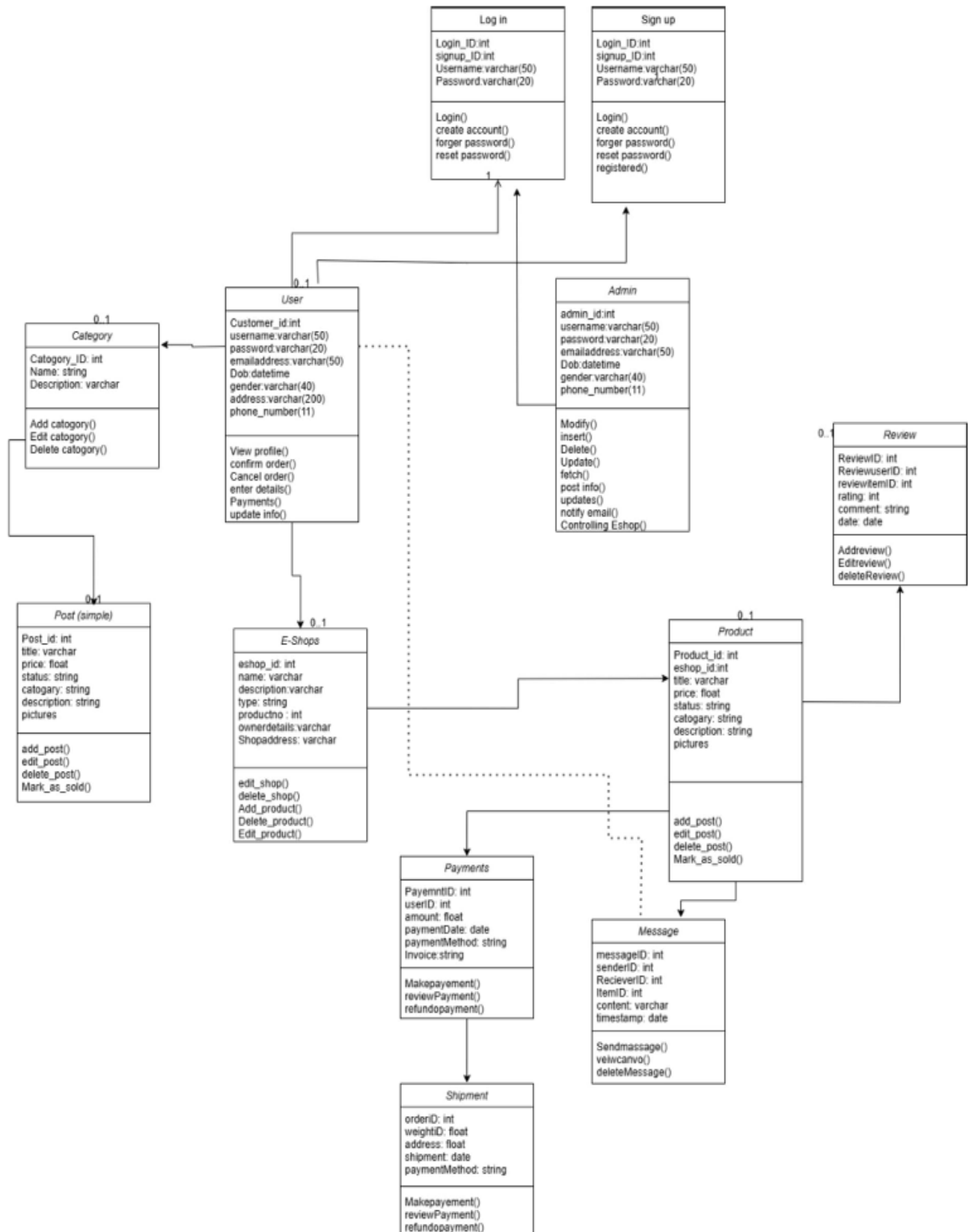


Figure 5: Class Diagram

4.4.3 Sequence Diagram

The Sequence Diagram shows the interactions between the different system components during the product purchase process. It illustrates how the buyer, system, payment gateway, and seller communicate during a transaction.

4.4.3.1 System Sequence Diagram

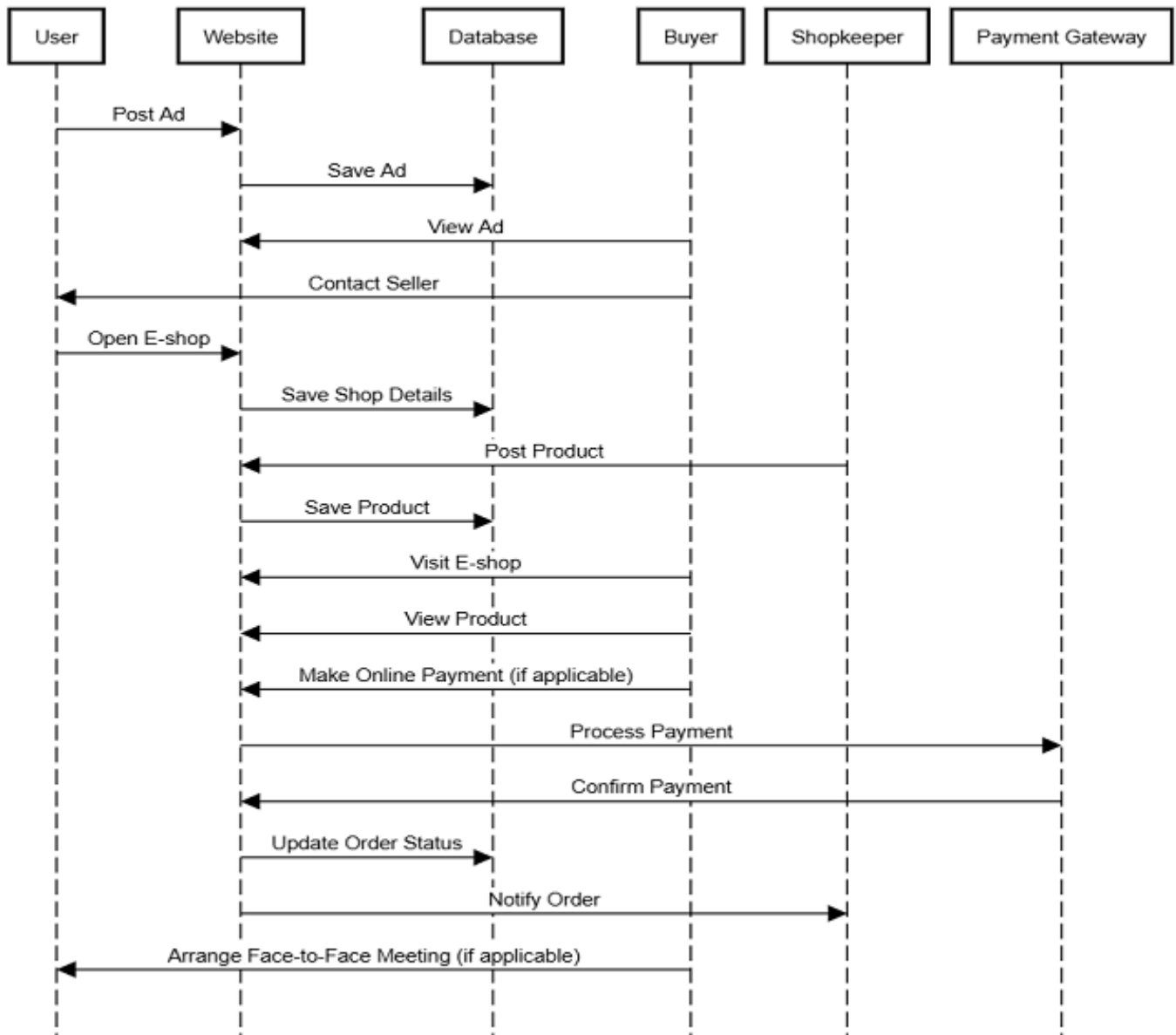


Figure 6: System Sequence Diagram

4.4.3.2 Sequence Diagram: User Registration

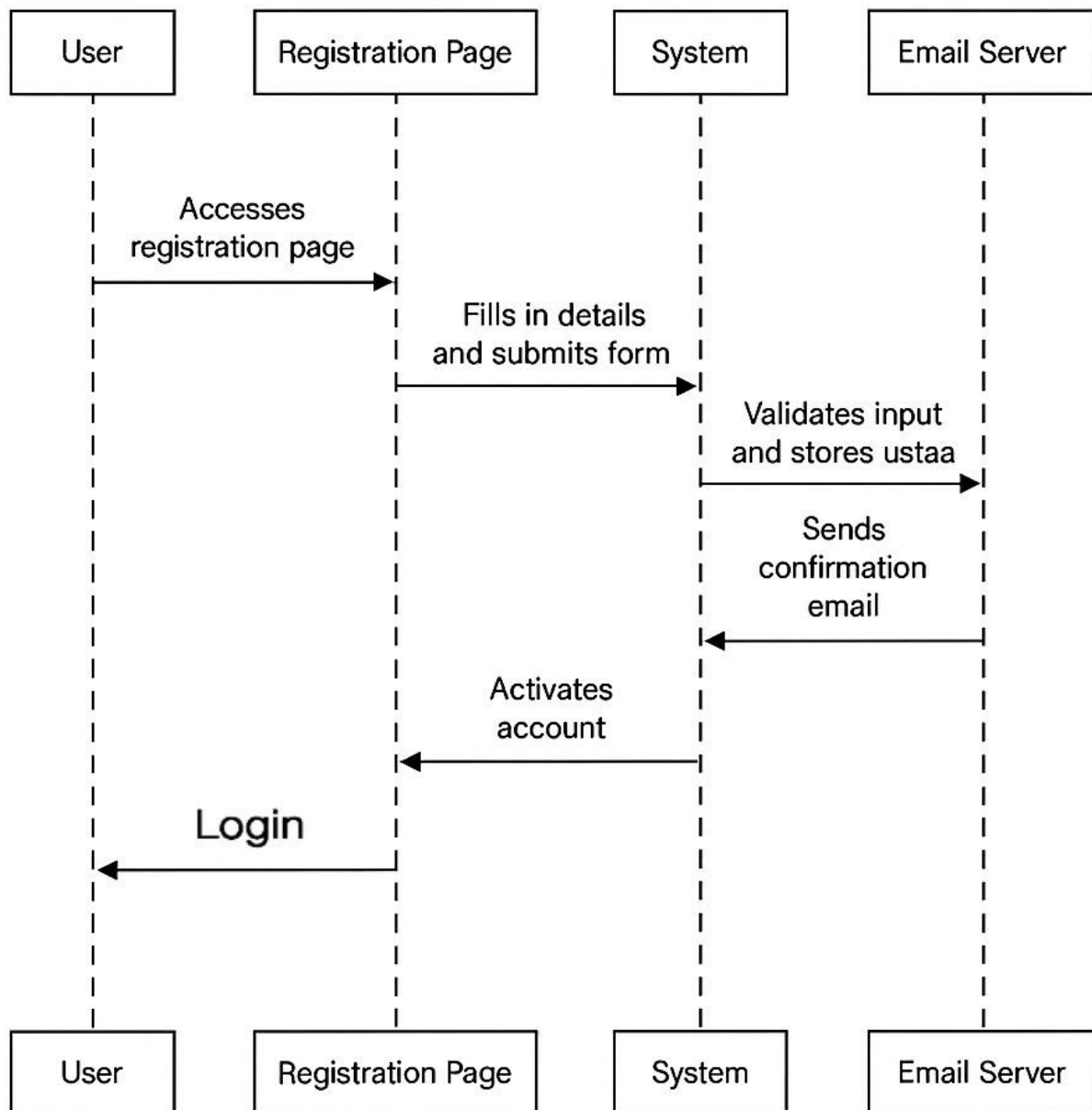


Figure 7: User Registration

4.4.3.3 Sequence Diagram: Product listing

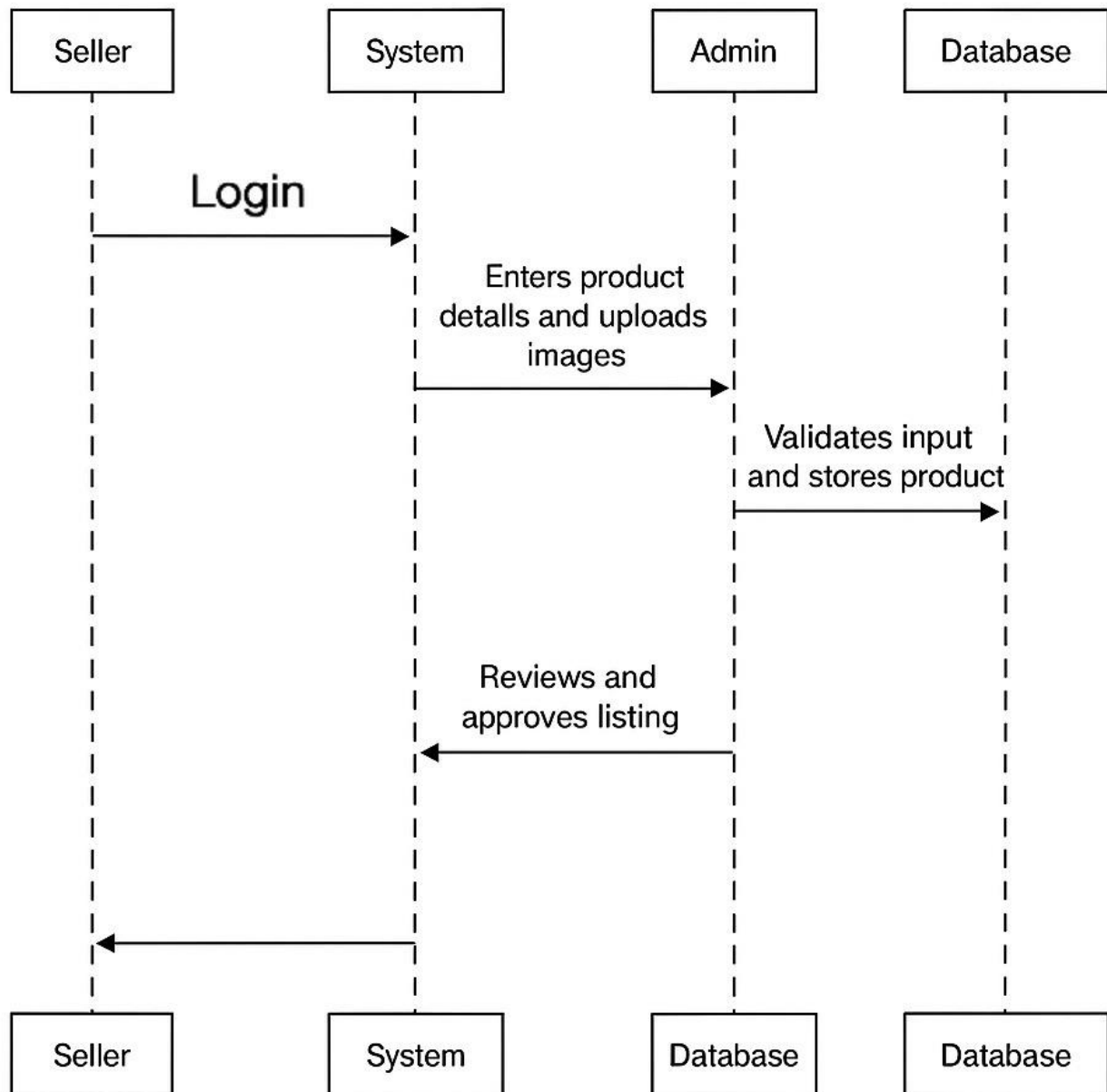


Figure 8: Product listing

4.4.3.4 Sequence Diagram: Checkout (buyer)

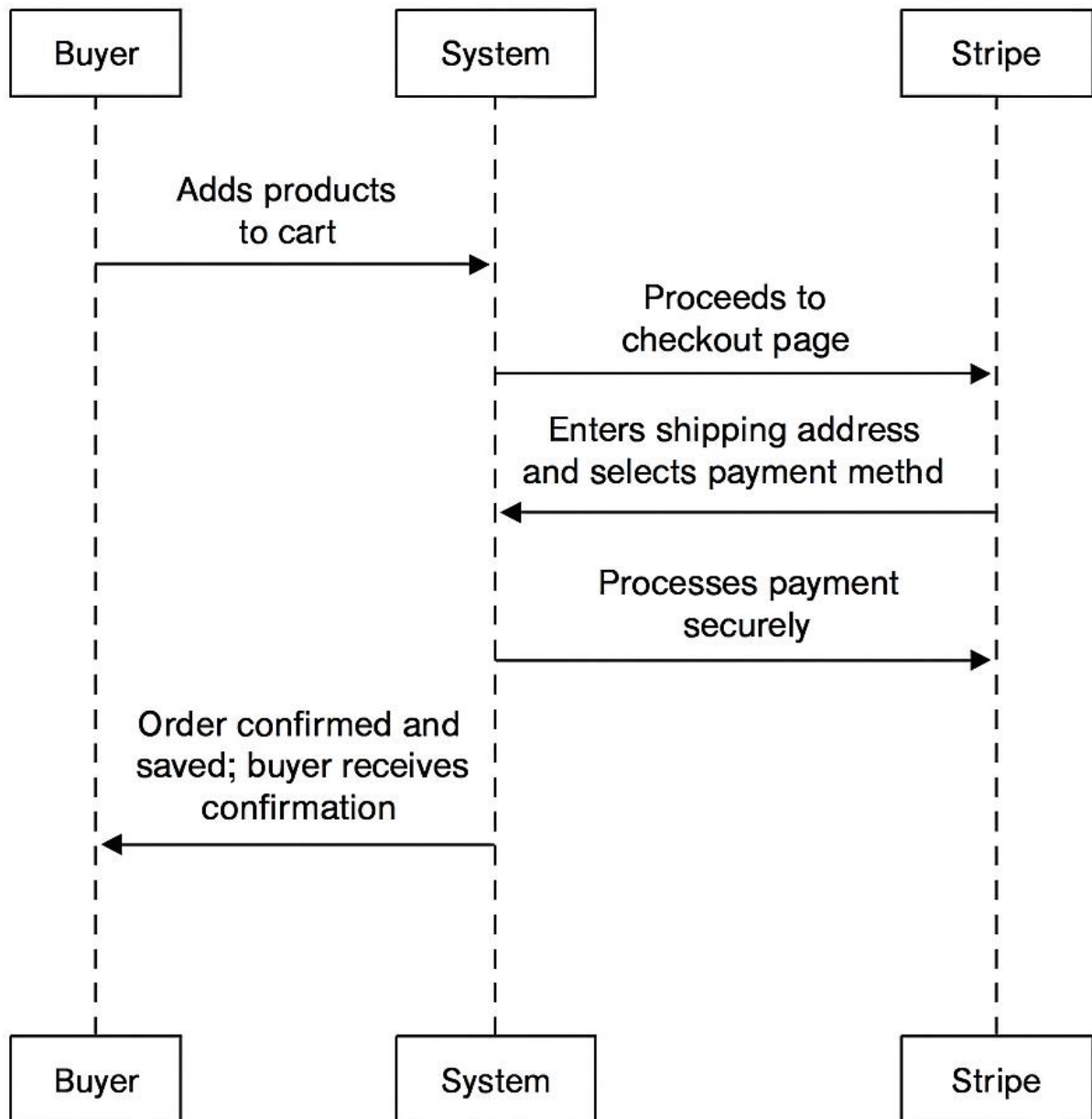


Figure 9: Checkout (buyer)

4.4.3.5 Sequence Diagram: View Ads

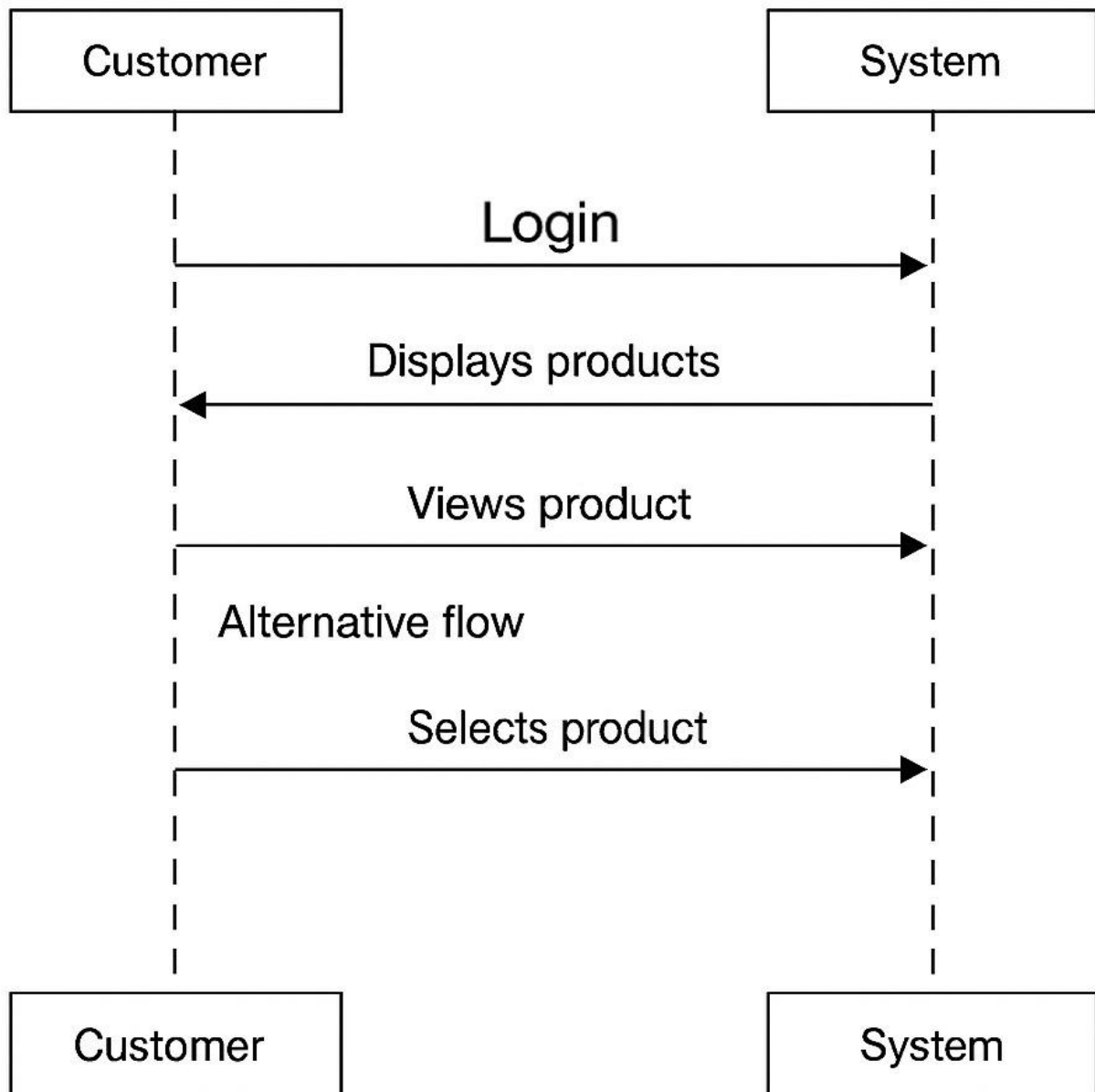


Figure 10: View Ads

4.4.3.6 Sequence Diagram: Login Admin

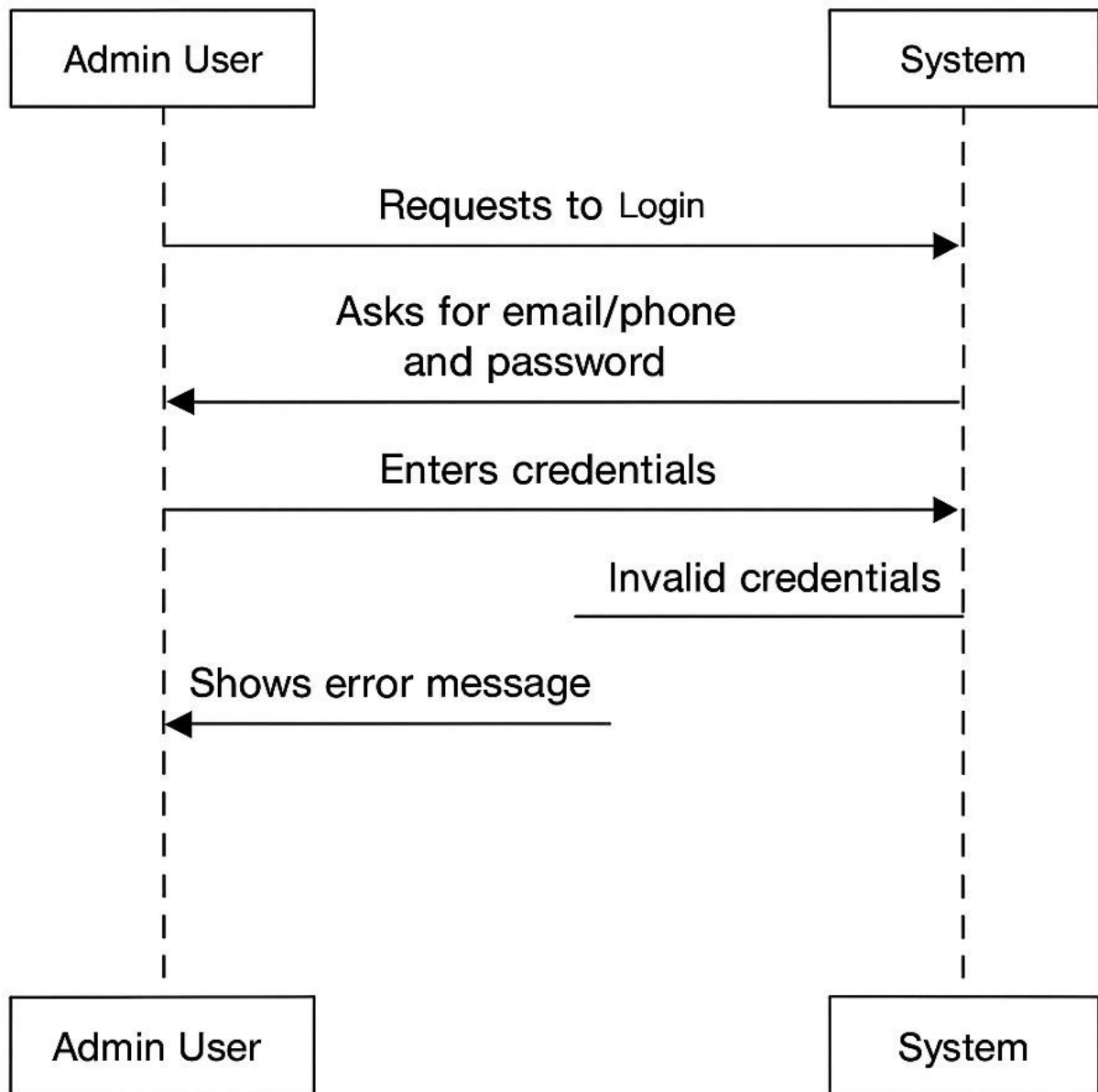


Figure 11: Login Admin

4.4.3.7 Sequence Diagram: Posting Adds

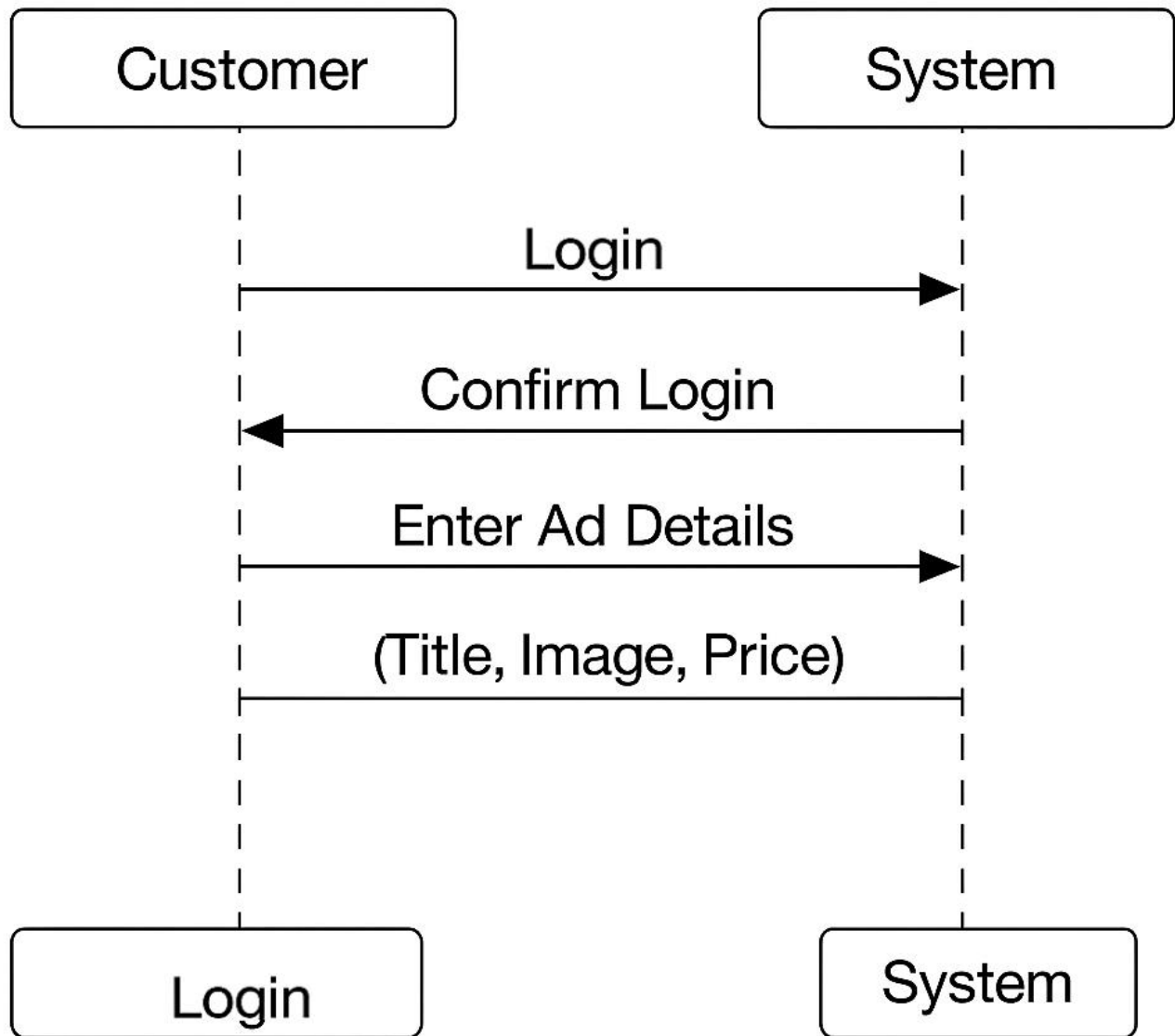


Figure 12: Posting Adds

4.4.3.8 Sequence Diagram: Payment Processing

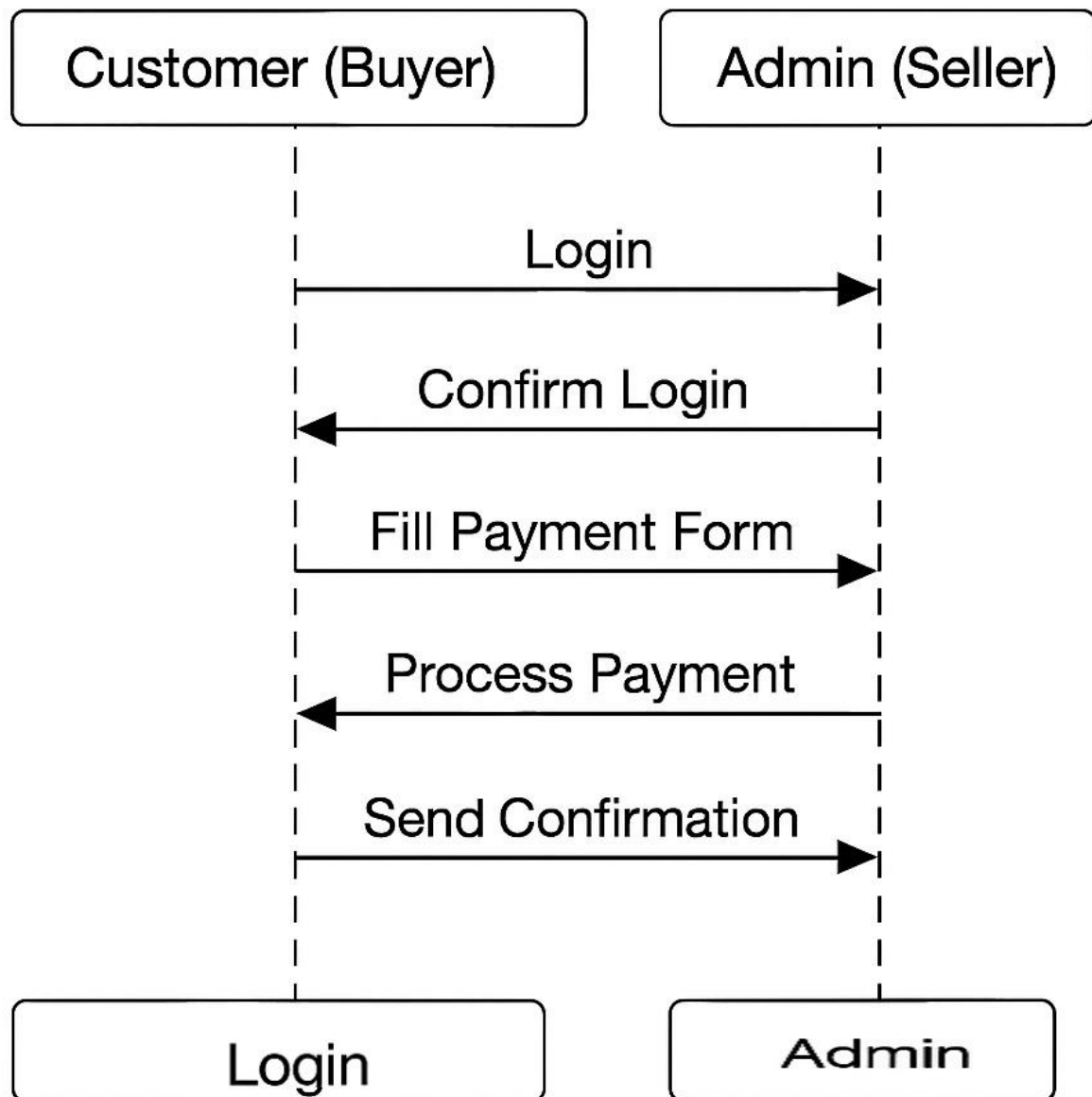


Figure 13: Payment Processing

4.4.3.9 Sequence Diagram: E-Shop

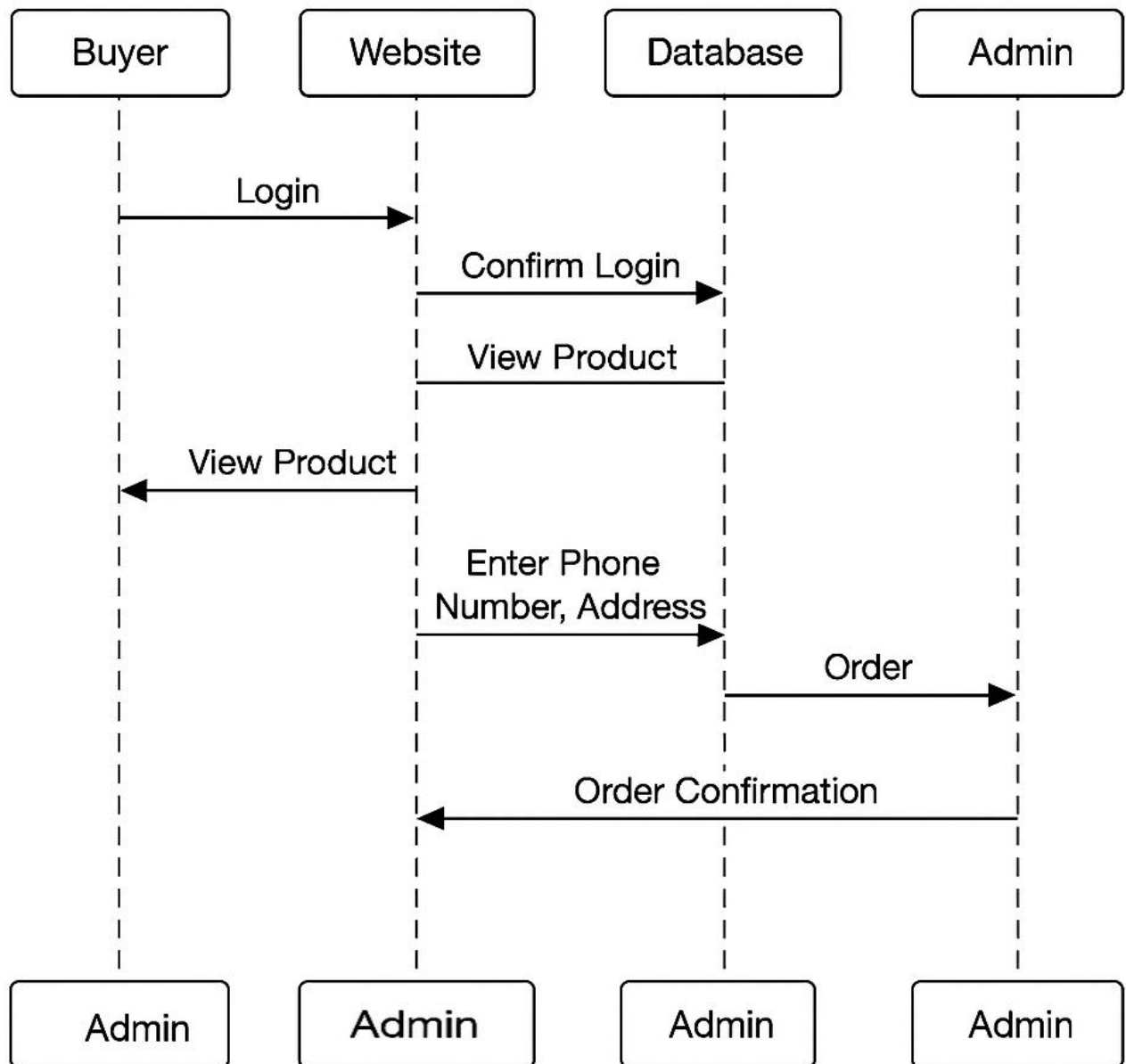


Figure 14: E-Shop

Sequence Diagram: Buyer Seller Communication

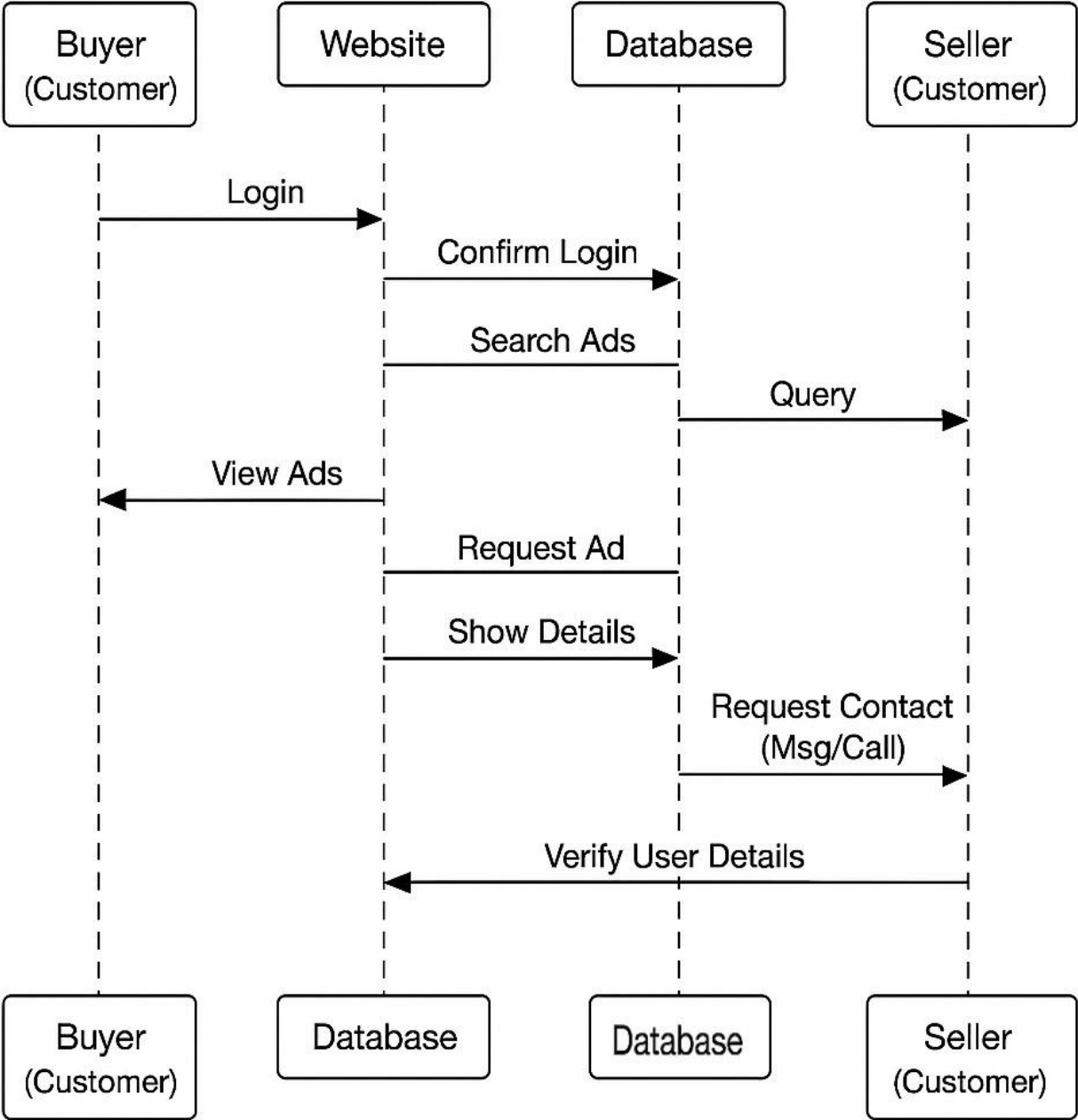


Figure 15: Buyer Seller Communication

4.4.3.10 Sequence Diagram: Product Adds

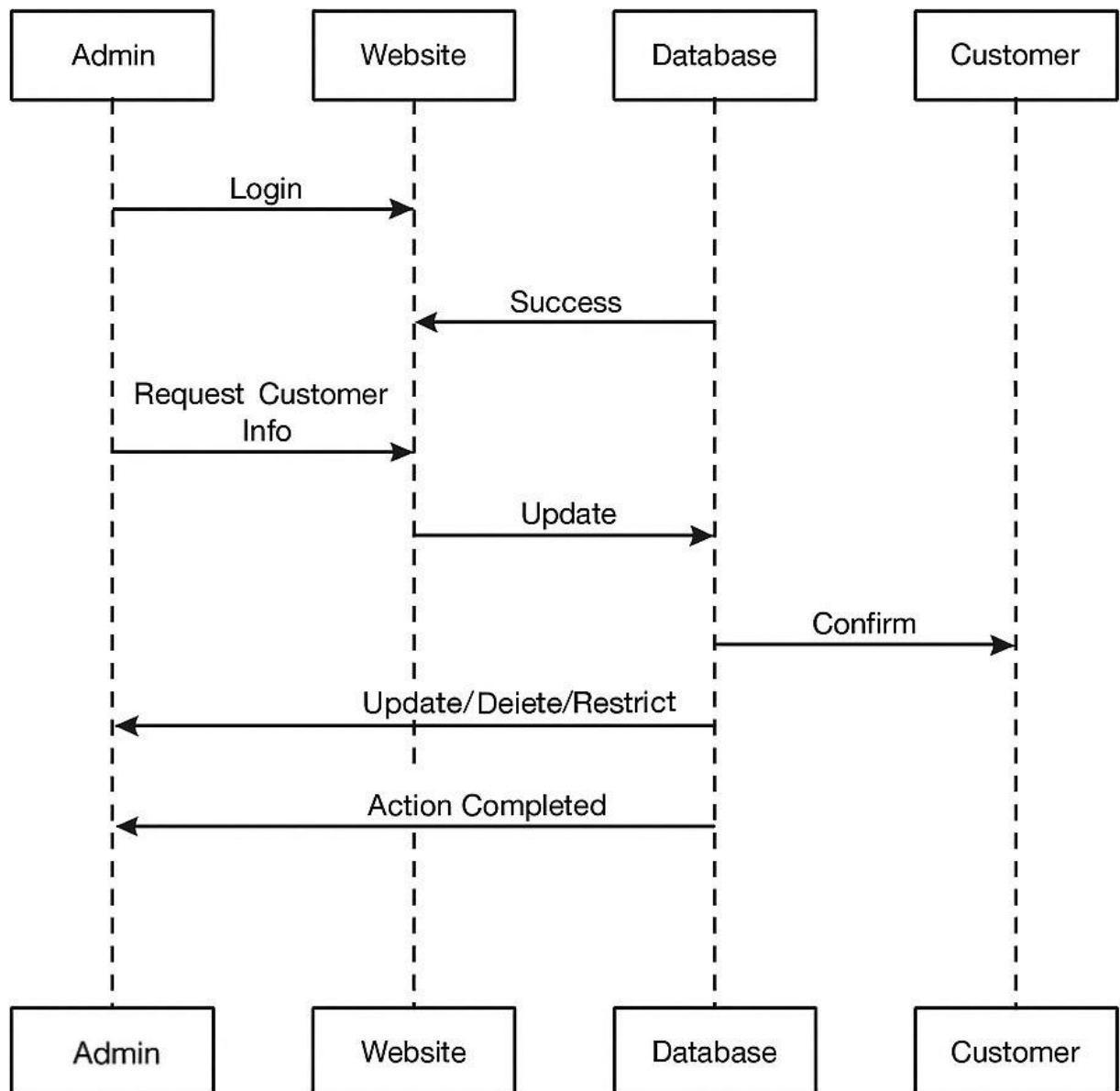


Figure 16: Product Adds

4.4.3.11 Sequence Diagram: Edit Profile

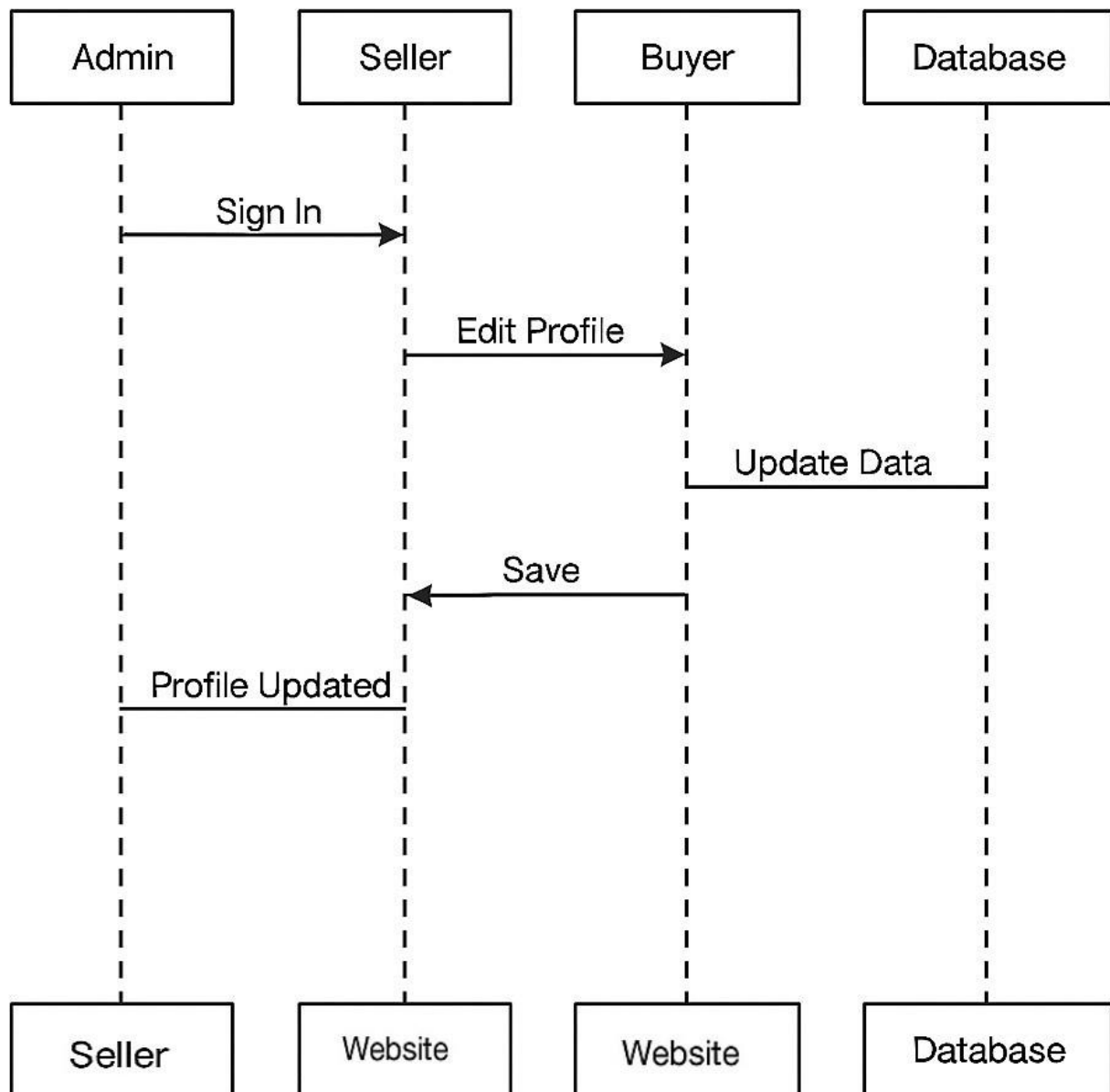


Figure 17: Edit Profile

4.4.3.12 Sequence Diagram: Post Ads

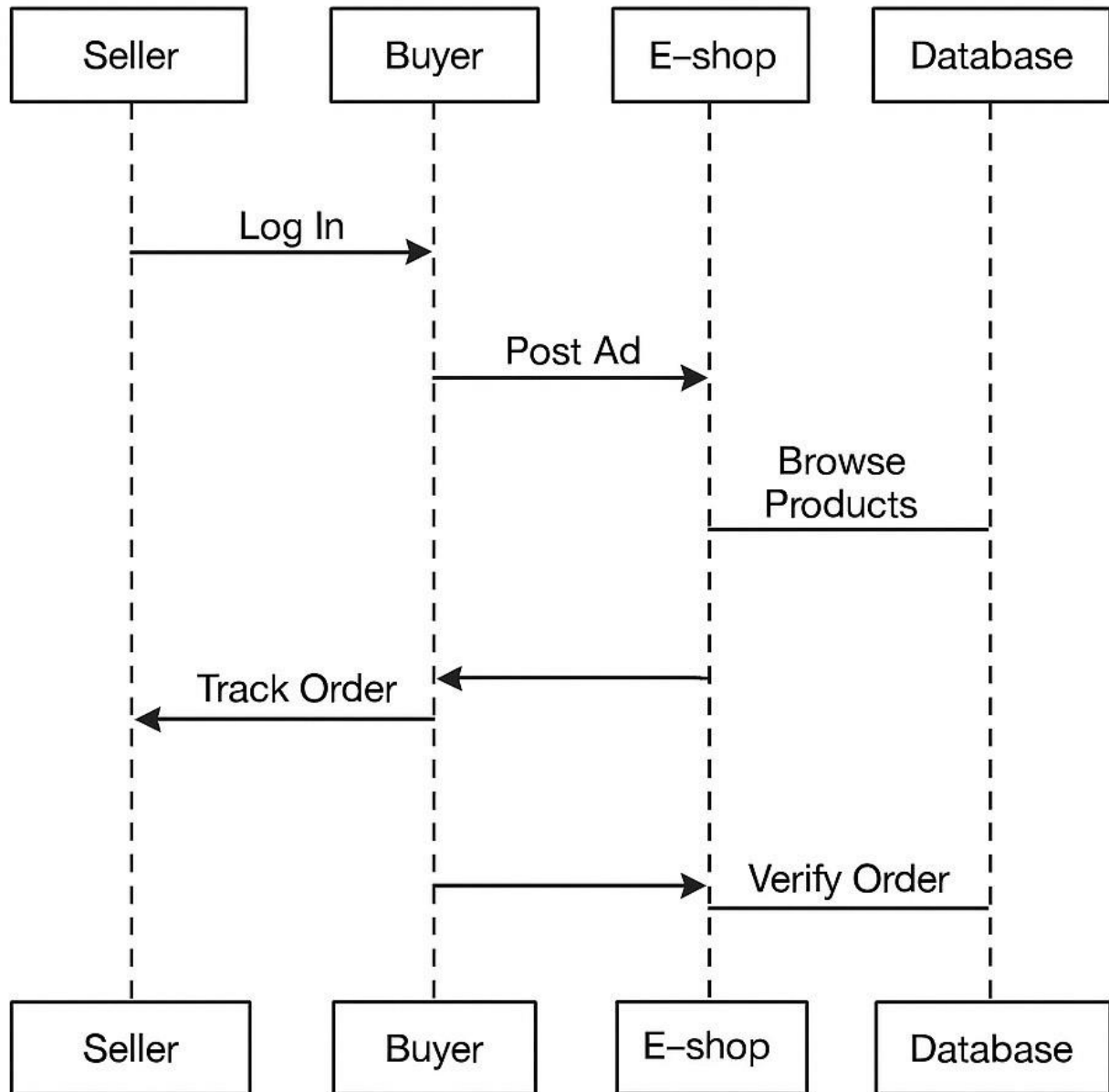


Figure 18: Post Ads

4.4.4 ER Diagram:

The Entity-Relationship (ER) Diagram represents the logical structure of the database used in our e-commerce system. It identifies the key entities involved in the system and defines the relationships among them to support core functionalities like user management, product catalog, shopping cart, and order processing. This diagram serves as the blueprint for database implementation. It ensures that all necessary data is captured accurately and that the relationships between entities reflect the real-world business logic of an online shopping platform.

5 Key Entities:

- **User:** Stores information about the registered users, including their credentials and roles (e.g., customer or admin).
- **Product:** Represents items available in the store with attributes such as name, description, price, and stock.
- **Order:** Captures the details of a purchase made by a user, including the date and total amount.
- **OrderItem:** A junction table that records the specific products and quantities included in each order.
- **Cart:** Represents the temporary selection of items a user wishes to purchase before finalizing the order.
- **CartItem:** Contains the individual products added to the user's cart with quantity information.

6 Relationships:

- A User can have multiple Orders and one Cart.
- Each Order contains multiple OrderItems, and each OrderItem is linked to a specific Product.
- The Cart is associated with CartItems, and each CartItem also references a Product.

7 Normalization:

The ER diagram is designed to ensure that the database follows normalization rules up to 3NF. This helps eliminate data redundancy and maintain data integrity. For instance:

- Product details are stored in a separate table and referenced using foreign keys in related tables.
- The many-to-many relationships (such as between Orders and Products) are handled using junction tables like OrderItem and CartItem.

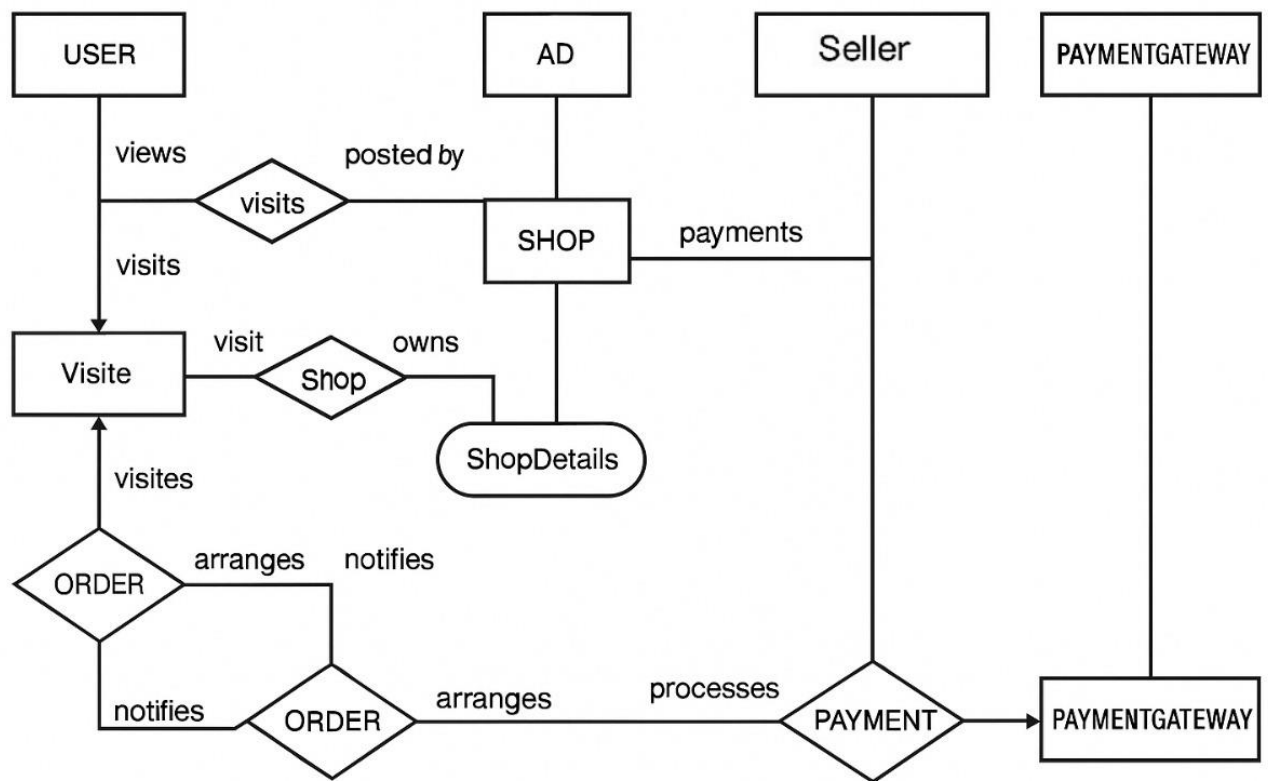


Figure 19: ER Diagram

Chapter 5: Implementation

8 Implementation

This chapter presents the technical realization of the proposed system, focusing on how various components were developed and integrated. It includes descriptions of core functionalities, system architecture, module-level implementation, and relevant UML diagrams such as class diagrams, sequence diagrams, or activity diagrams, where applicable. Source code is not included but may be referenced conceptually to explain key implementation decisions. The content is tailored to reflect the specific technologies and tools used in the project.

8.1.1 Implementation Overview

The ReSellZone system was implemented using:

- Frontend: HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap 5, JavaScript (with optional jQuery)
- Backend: PHP (Laravel/Vanilla PHP), JavaScript (Node.js) (*as applicable*)
- Database: MySQL
- Authentication: Session-based login for users/admins; email validation
- Payment Integration: Stripe API

8.2 Major Modules and Algorithms

This chapter presents the algorithms and logical workflows that drive the core functionalities of the ReSellZone e-commerce platform. The platform facilitates interaction between buyers and sellers, enabling secure transactions, product listings, order processing, and administrative control. Each major module has been implemented using Laravel's MVC structure, supported by Eloquent ORM and secure middleware layers. The following sections describe the key operational algorithms in pseudocode and descriptive format.

8.2.1 Shopping Cart and Checkout Workflow

Module: Cart and Checkout

Objective: Enable buyers to add products to a virtual cart and proceed to secure checkout.

Algorithm: Manage Shopping Cart

- User selects a product and clicks "Add to Cart"

- System checks if the product already exists in the cart
 - If yes, increment quantity
 - If no, add product with quantity = 1
- Cart is stored in session or linked to user ID (if logged in)
- At checkout:
 - Display all cart items with quantities and total price
 - Allow modifications (update quantity, remove items)

Explanation:

The shopping cart is dynamically managed and preserved across the user's session. At checkout, the cart is validated and prepared for order processing.

8.2.2 Secure Order Placement and Processing

Module: Order Management

Objective: Generate and store order records, link them to users, and notify sellers.

Algorithm: Place Order

- Validate cart data and buyer shipping information
- Begin database transaction
- Create a new order record with:
 - Buyer ID, total price, shipping address
 - Status = 'processing'
- For each item in the cart:
 - Create order item record linked to the order
 - Reduce product stock if applicable
- Commit transaction
- Notify seller of new order

Explanation:

This ensures data consistency using transactional operations and links multiple ordered products to a single order ID for efficient tracking.

8.2.3 Stripe Payment Gateway Integration

Module: Payment Processing

Objective: Handle secure credit/debit card payments using Stripe.

Algorithm: Process Stripe Payment

- Frontend collects payment info and generates a Stripe token

- Send token and payment amount to backend
- On server:
 - Use Stripe API to create a charge
 - If successful:
 - Update order status to 'paid'
 - Store transaction ID in payment table
 - Send confirmation to user and seller
 - If failed:
 - Notify user of payment error

Explanation:

Stripe ensures PCI-compliant, secure payment processing. Laravel handles this via controller actions using the Stripe SDK.

8.2.4 Admin Panel Workflow

Module: Admin Dashboard

Objective: Allow the administrator to manage products, users, orders, and seller approvals.

Algorithm: Admin Operations

- Login to admin panel (secured route middleware)
- Access management sections:
 - Products: View, approve/reject, delete
 - Sellers: Approve pending accounts
 - Orders: View order status and payment verification
 - Users: Ban or warn users, reset credentials
- Use CRUD operations through admin controllers
- Generate reports and statistics as needed

Explanation:

Admins have access to elevated features to ensure quality control, content moderation, and operational oversight of the platform.

8.2.5 Seller Dashboard and Product Management

Module: Seller Portal

Objective: Enable approved sellers to manage their listings and process orders.

Algorithm: Seller Dashboard Work flow

- Seller logs into the dedicated dashboard
- Access available features:
 - Add/edit/delete product listings
 - View product status (pending/approved)
 - View incoming orders, order status
 - Manage account info (store name, contact)
- Use Laravel controllers to handle database operations
- Receive notifications on new orders or admin actions

Explanation:

Sellers operate within a secure panel that gives them control over their storefront while ensuring admin oversight for quality assurance.

8.2.6 Courier Service Integration

Module: Delivery Management

Objective: Send order data to a courier API for shipment and tracking.

- On admin/seller confirmation:
 - Send order details to courier API
- Receive shipment ID and tracking link
- Store tracking info in order record
- Notify buyer via email/SMS with tracking URL

Explanation:

This module helps automate delivery initiation and allows buyers to track their packages via third-party services.

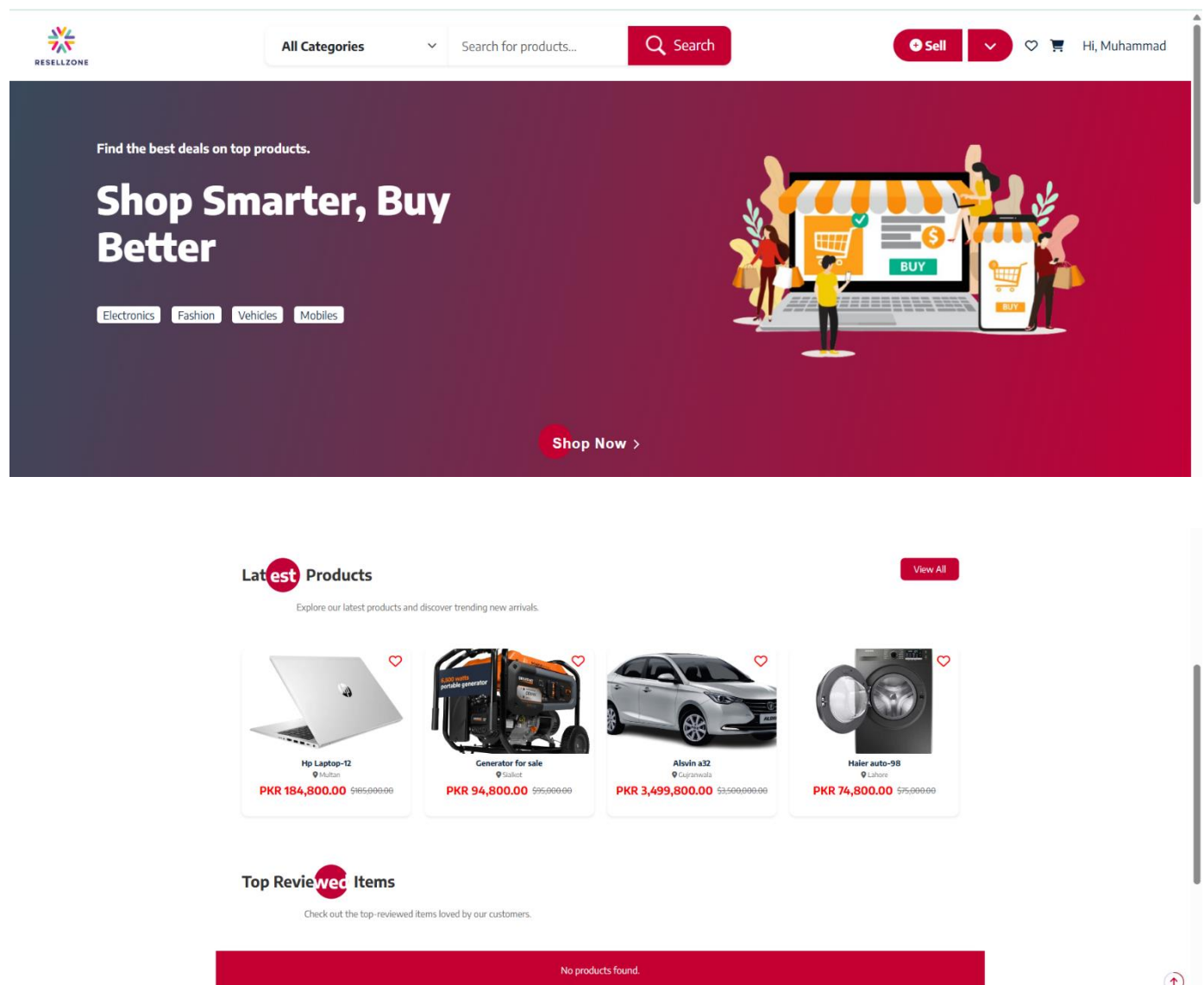
8.3 External APIs:

The following table presents a comprehensive analysis of the third-party APIs integrated within the ReSellZone platform, detailing their technical roles, implementation purposes, and corresponding code-level references. These APIs were selected based on insights from the literature review and industry best practices to enhance functionality in key areas such as user authentication, social login, and secure online payment processing. Each entry outlines the API's core description, its specific purpose in the context of the application, and the function or class where it is invoked. The integration of these APIs not only streamlines critical user interactions but also reinforces the system's overall security, reliability, and user accessibility. Their usage reflects a modular development approach, allowing for easier maintenance, scalability, and future extension of platform features. Additionally, adopting trusted third-party services ensures compliance with modern web standards and user expectations regarding privacy and data protection.

Table 15: List of External APIs Integrated for Authentication and Payment Services

Name of API	Description of API	Purpose of usage	List down the function/class name in which it is used
Google APIs	Provides authentication and other Google services (e.g., login via Gmail)	Used for Google Sign-In functionality	SocialLoginController, handleGoogleCallback()
Stripe API	Payment processing API for online transactions	To handle secure payment gateway and process transactions	StripePaymentController, processPayment()
Facebook API	Enables login/authentication through Facebook	Used for Facebook social login	SocialLoginController, Handle FacebookCallback()
App Password (OAuth2 Socialite)	Application-specific password or OAuth token used for secure logins	Used as part of authentication flow for third-party logins	SocialLoginController, redirectToProvider()

8.3.1.1 System's User Interface Designs:



Shop **Freely**

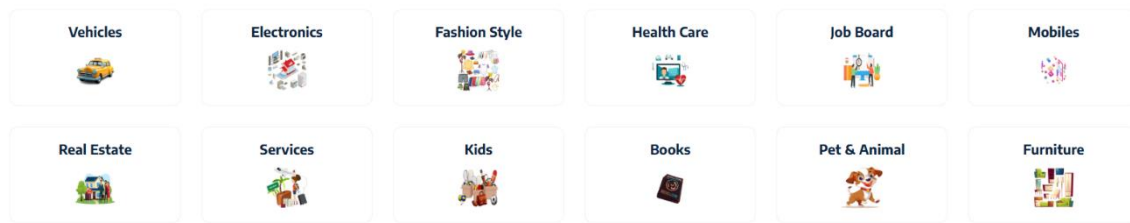


Figure 20: Landing Page

All Categories

Search for products...

Search

Hi, Muhammad

Fill Out the Form to Post Your Ad Effortlessly!

Home > add Product

Need help getting started?
Review these resources to learn how to create a great ad and increase your selling chances.

- Tips for improving your ads and your chances of selling
- All you need to know about Posting Ads

You can always come back to change your ad.

Post Your Adds for Sale

Which Category you want to sell*

Generators

Upload Images in Format jpeg, png, jpg, gif, svg* (Upload up to 12 images)

Selected ID

Title*

Enter title

Description*

Enter a detailed description

Name*

Enter your name

Price*

Enter Price

Location*

Select Region

City*

Enter your city

Contact No*

Enter your 10 digit phone number

Enter Your 9 digit phone number

Submit

All Categories

Search for products...

Search

Hi, Muhammad

Fill Out the Form to Post Your Ad Effortlessly!

Home > add Product

Need help getting started?

Review these resources to learn how to create a great ad and increase your selling chances.

- [Tips for improving your ads and your chances of selling](#)
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You can always come back to change your ad.

Post Your Adds for Sale

Which Category you want to sell*

Generators

Upload Images in Format jpeg, png, jpg, gif, svg* (Upload up to 12 images)

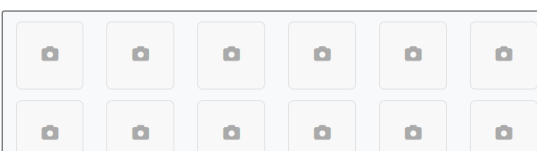
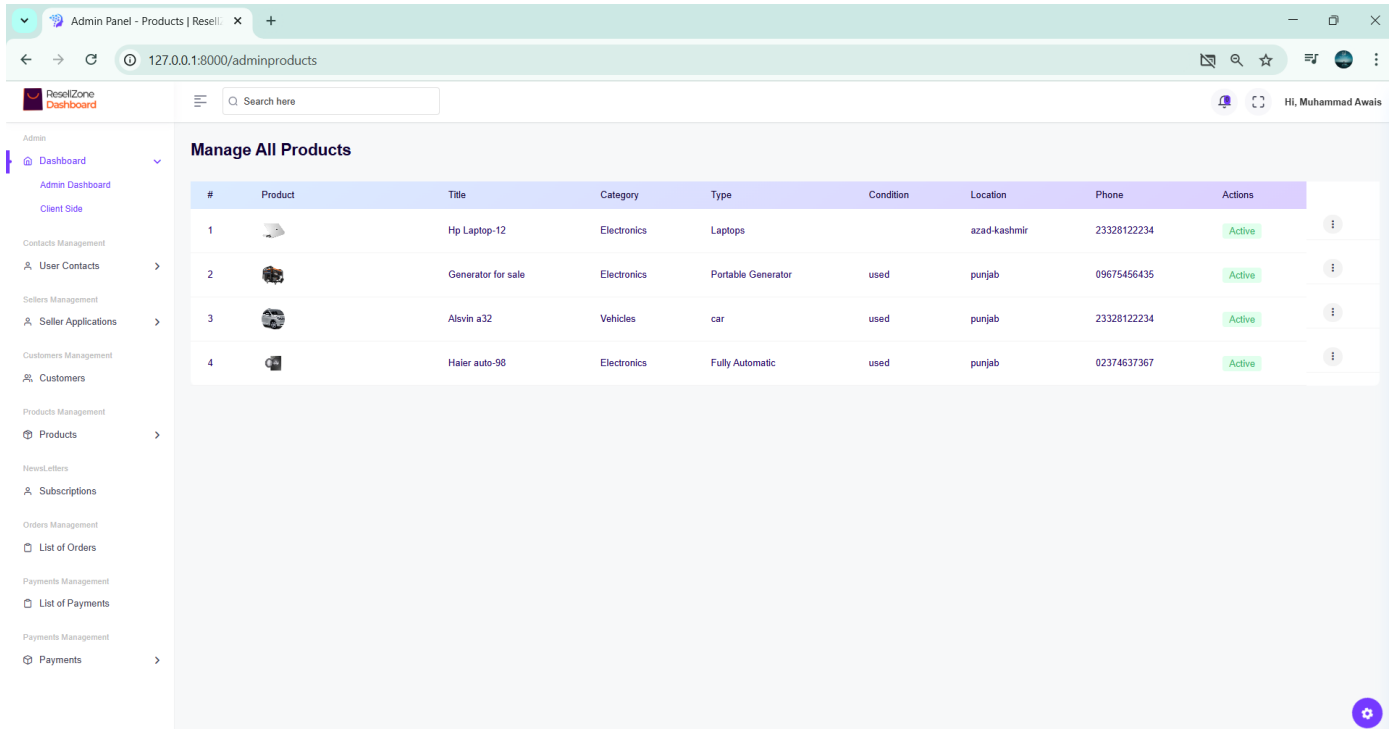


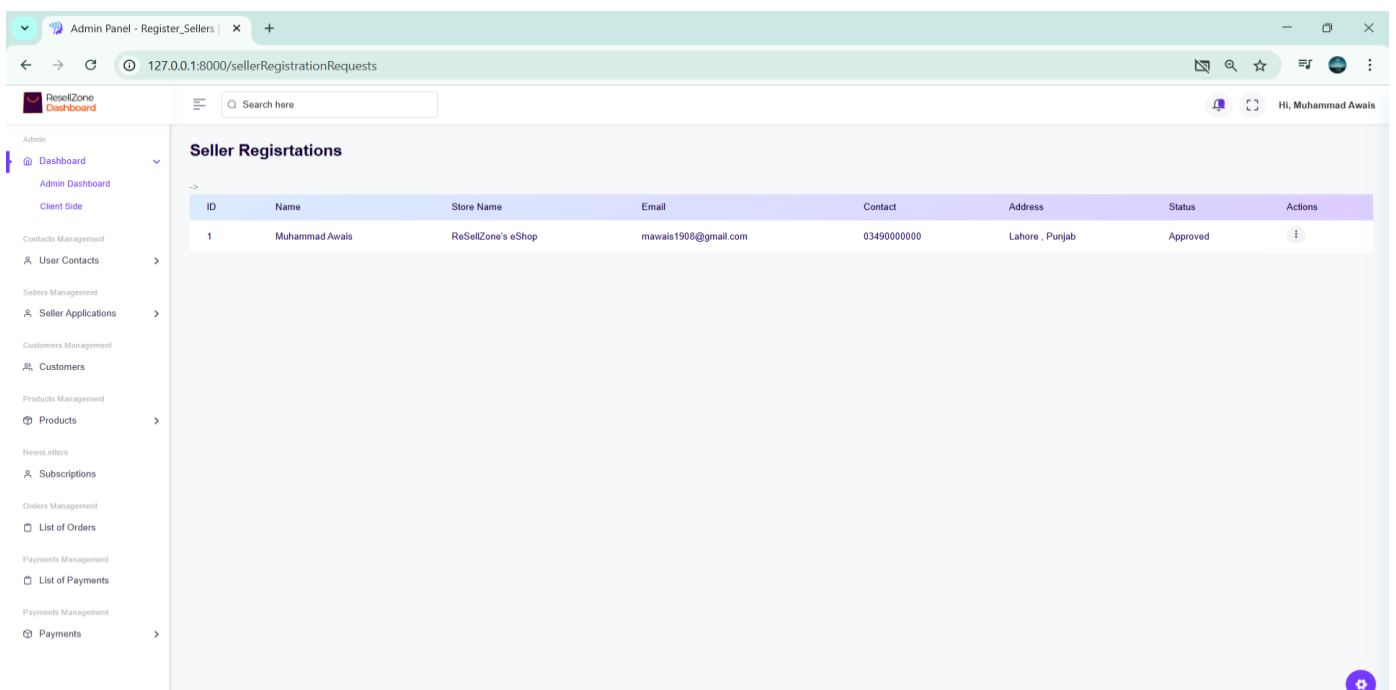
Figure 21: Add New Product Listing



The screenshot shows the 'Admin Panel - Products | ResellZone' interface. The left sidebar contains navigation links for Admin (Dashboard, Admin Dashboard, Client Side) and Client Side (Contacts Management, User Contacts, Sellers Management, Seller Applications, Customers Management, Customers, Products, News/Letters, Subscriptions, Orders Management, List of Orders, Payments Management, List of Payments, Payments Management, Payments). The main content area is titled 'Manage All Products' and displays a table with the following data:

#	Product	Title	Category	Type	Condition	Location	Phone	Actions
1		Hp Laptop-12	Electronics	Laptops		azad-kashmir	23328122234	Active
2		Generator for sale	Electronics	Portable Generator	used	punjab	09675456435	Active
3		Alsvin a32	Vehicles	car	used	punjab	23328122234	Active
4		Haier auto-98	Electronics	Fully Automatic	used	punjab	02374637367	Active

Figure 22: Product Management (Admin Panel)



The screenshot shows the 'Admin Panel - Register_Sellers' interface. The left sidebar contains navigation links for Admin (Dashboard, Admin Dashboard, Client Side) and Client Side (Contacts Management, User Contacts, Sellers Management, Seller Applications, Customers Management, Customers, Products, News/Letters, Subscriptions, Orders Management, List of Orders, Payments Management, List of Payments, Payments Management, Payments). The main content area is titled 'Seller Registrations' and displays a table with the following data:

ID	Name	Store Name	Email	Contact	Address	Status	Actions
1	Muhammad Awais	ReSellZone's eShop	mawais1908@gmail.com	03490000000	Lahore . Punjab	Approved	

Figure 23: Seller Shop Registration Management (Admin)

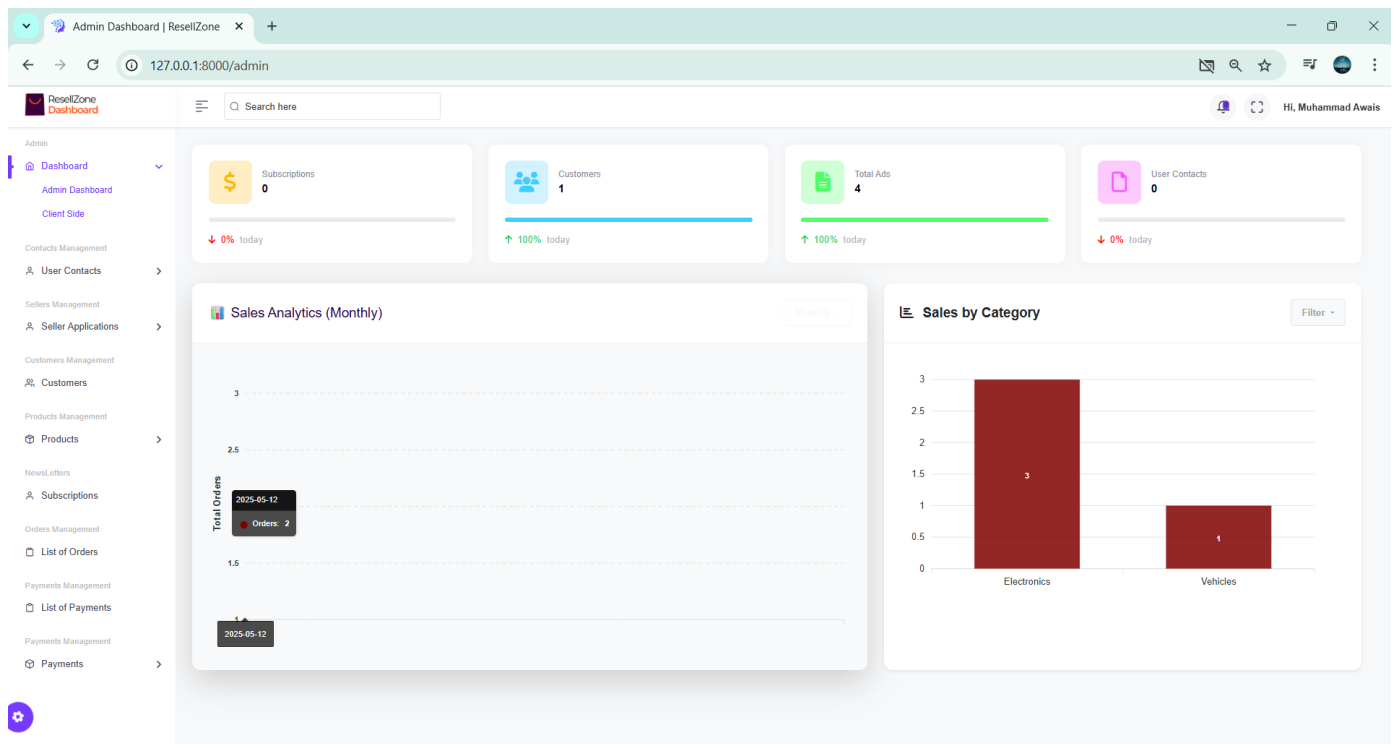


Figure 24: Admin Dashboard

Write a Review

Leave a Review

✗ Only customers who have purchased and received this product can leave a review.

Ask a Question

Have a question?

Type your question...

Submit Question

Figure 25: Product Reviews & Customer Questions

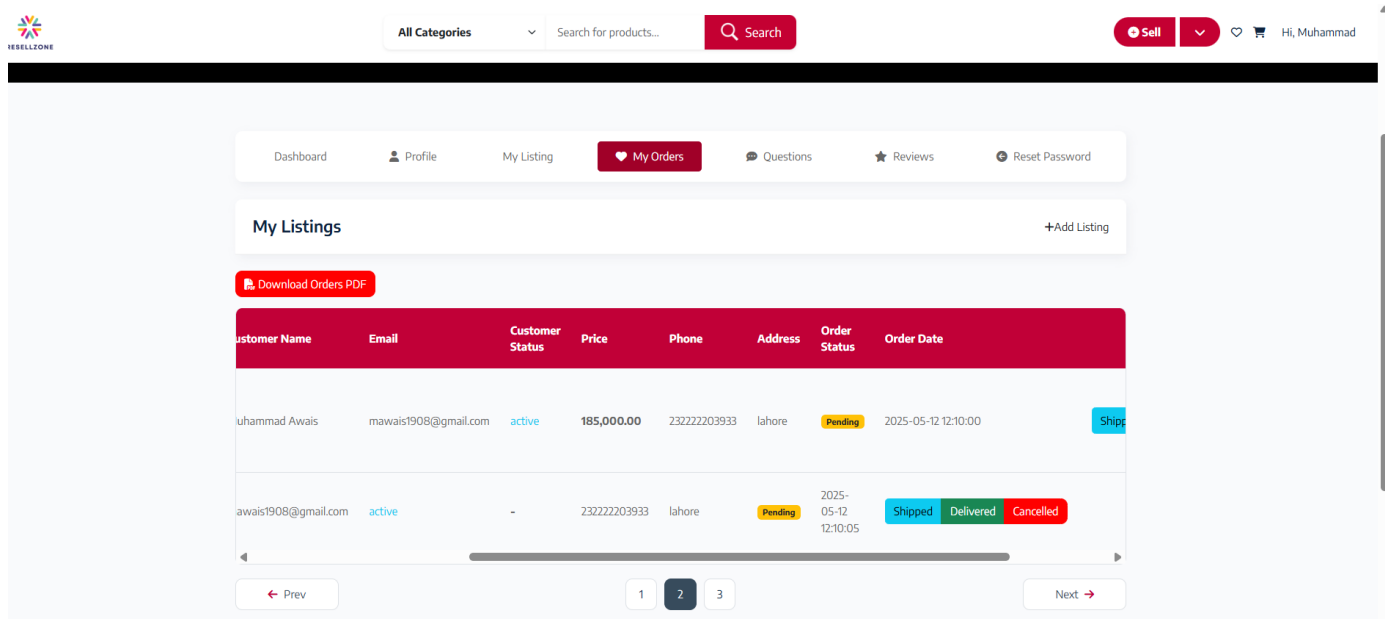


Figure 26: Seller Dashboard – Product Listings

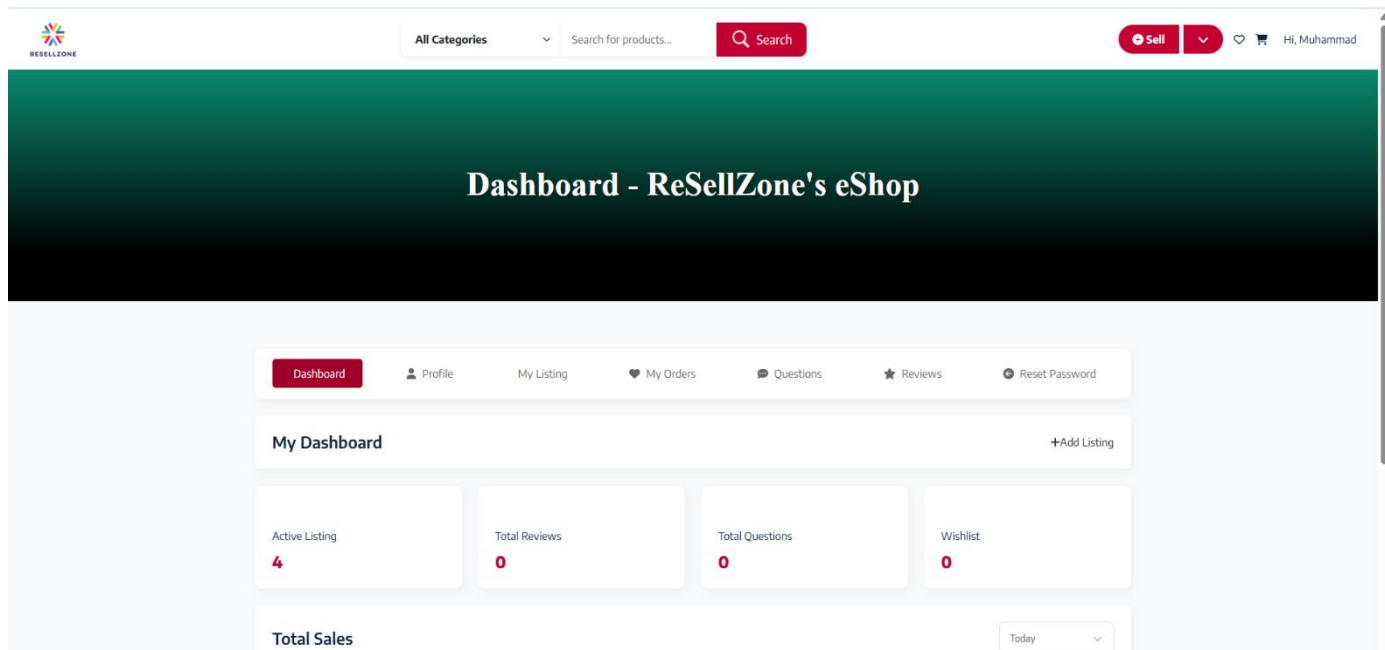


Figure 27: Seller Dashboard



All CategoriesSearch for products...Search

SellHi, Muhammad

Billing Details

Full Name *

Muhammad Awais

Address *

Lahore

Phone *

232222203933

Email Address *

mawais1908@gmail.com

Short Message (Optional)

Special delivery instructions

Your Order

Product	Subtotal
Hp Laptop-12	PKR 185,000.00
Qty: 1	
Subtotal	PKR 185,000.00
Total	PKR 185,250.00

Choose Payment Method

Cash on Delivery

Pay via Stripe

Place Order

Figure 28: Customer Checkout Flow

Chapter 6: Testing and Evaluation

9 Testing and Evaluation

This chapter outlines the testing processes applied to the ReSellZone platform. It includes both manual and automated testing to verify that the system meets its functional and non-functional requirements. Testing ensures that the application performs accurately, securely, and efficiently under different conditions and user roles (buyer, seller, admin).

9.1 Manual Testing

9.1.1 System Testing

System testing is performed after the full integration of all modules. It includes unit testing, functional testing, and integration testing.

9.1.2 Unit Testing

9.1.2.1 Unit Test 1: Login Functionality

The following table presents a set of functional test cases designed to validate the role-based login system implemented in the ReSellZone platform. Each test case includes specific input credentials associated with distinct user roles—buyer, seller, and admin—along with the expected system behavior and actual result. This testing ensures that the authentication flow correctly redirects users to their respective dashboards, verifying both role-based access control and system responsiveness. The results confirm that the login mechanism performs reliably across all user types, To ensure the login system works correctly for all user roles.

Table 16: Functional Test Cases for Multi-Role User Login System

No.	Test Case	Input / Attribute Values	Expected Result	Result
1	Login as a Buyer	Email: buyer@test.com Password: 1234	Redirect to buyer dashboard	Pass
2	Login as a Seller	Email: seller@test.com Password: 1234	Redirect to seller dashboard	Pass
3	Login as an Admin	Email: admin@test.com Password: 1234	Redirect to admin dashboard	Pass

9.1.2.2 Unit Test 2: Edit Profile

The table below presents test cases for the user profile update functionality in ReSellZone. It evaluates both valid and invalid input scenarios to ensure proper validation and user feedback, confirming that the system correctly handles updates and enforces required field constraints. Ensure users can update their profile details successfully.

Table 17: Functional Test Cases for Edit Profile Feature

No.	Test Case	Input / Attribute Values	Expected Result	Result
1	Edit name and phone number	Name: Ali KhanPhone: 03211234567	Profile updated message shown	Pass
2	Leave phone number blank	Name: Ali KhanPhone: [blank]	Error message for required field	Pass

9.1.3 Functional Testing

Functional Test 1: Role-Based Dashboard Navigation

The following table outlines test cases for verifying role-based dashboard access within ReSellZone. Each scenario tests login credentials for different user types and validates that the system grants access to the appropriate dashboard interface with role-specific features and permissions. These test cases confirm that the system enforces role-specific permissions and ensures a personalized user experience aligned with functional requirements. Verify that each role is redirected to their correct dashboard with appropriate access.

Table 18: Functional Testing of Role-Based Dashboard Navigation

No.	Test Case	Input / Attribute Values	Expected Result	Result
1	Login as Buyer	buyer@test.com / 1234	Buyer Dashboard with limited navigation	Pass
2	Login as Seller	seller@test.com / 1234	Seller Dashboard with product management	Pass
3	Login as Admin	admin@test.com / 1234	Admin Panel with approval controls	Pass

9.1.4 Integration Testing

The following test case validates the profile access functionality for a logged-in buyer within the ReSellZone platform. It ensures that upon successful authentication, the system correctly redirects the user to their personal profile page, confirming that profile routing and session-based access control are functioning as intended.

Table 19: Functional Testing of Role-Based Dashboard Navigation

No.	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Result
1	Login as Buyer and view profile	Email: buyer@test.com / 1234	Redirect to buyer profile page	Pass

The following test case verifies the product upload functionality for sellers in ReSellZone. It confirms that when valid product details are submitted, the item is successfully added to the seller's inventory.

Table 20: Integration Test 2: Seller Product Upload

No.	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Result
2	Upload new product as Seller	Product Title, Price, Image	Product is listed under seller's inventory	Pass

The table below includes a test case that validates the admin's ability to approve pending product listings. It confirms that upon approval, the product status is correctly updated to "Approved," reflecting proper admin control and backend update functionality.

Table 21: Integration Test 3: Admin Product Approval

No.	Test Case	Input	Expected Result	Result
3	Approve pending product	Click "Approve" on product listing	Product status updated to "Approved"	Pass

9.2 Automated Testing

The following table presents an overview of the key development and testing tools utilized during the implementation of the ReSellZone platform, along with their specific applications and observed outcomes. Postman was employed for comprehensive API testing across critical routes such as user authentication, product listing, and admin approval, with all endpoints responding successfully with HTTP 200 OK status codes. PHP Unit was used to perform backend unit tests on Laravel controllers and core business logic, ensuring functional correctness and code stability—resulting in all tests passing without errors. MySQL Workbench facilitated direct inspection of the database schema and test data, confirming relational integrity and the accurate reflection of CRUD operations. Together, these tools ensured robustness, reliability, and a high level of confidence in the system’s functionality throughout the development lifecycle.

Table 22: Automated Testing Tools and Results

Tool Name	Purpose / Applied On	Results
Postman	API testing for login, registration, product upload, and admin approval routes	All APIs returned 200 OK
PHP Unit	Backend unit testing for controllers and core business logic in Laravel	All unit tests passed
MySQL Workbench	Used for database inspection, verifying relational integrity, and test data verification	Database tested OK

Chapter 7: Conclusion and Future Work

10 Conclusion and Future Work

10.1 Conclusion

The ReSellZone project was developed as an online platform that bridges the gap between buyers and sellers for second-hand and unused products. It provides a user-friendly, secure, and efficient environment for product listings, e-shop management, and communication between users. With dedicated dashboards for buyers, sellers, and admins, ReSellZone ensures role-based access control and smooth functionality across devices. Throughout the development cycle, we followed modern web development practices and employed a layered architecture to enhance scalability and maintainability. Functional modules such as login, registration, profile management, product uploads, and admin approval were successfully implemented and tested manually and automatically. This project demonstrates how technology can contribute to sustainability by encouraging reuse and reducing waste through digital resale opportunities.

10.2 Future Work

While the current version of ReSellZone meets the core objectives, there are several opportunities for enhancement in the future:

- **Mobile Application Integration:** Build native Android and iOS applications to enhance accessibility.
- **Chat/Messaging System:** Implement real-time messaging between buyers and sellers for quick communication.
- **AI-Based Recommendations:** Use machine learning algorithms to suggest products based on user behavior and interests.
- **Multi-language Support:** Expand the platform for users who speak different languages, improving global accessibility.
- **Blockchain for Transaction History:** Use blockchain to store immutable transaction logs for higher transparency.

These enhancements would increase the reliability, usability, and scalability of ReSellZone, making it a comprehensive solution in the second-hand marketplace domain.

Chapter 8: References

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